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For the first time in India
97% of women honoured,
A historic step by the Punjab Government

MUKH MANTRI MAWAN-DHIAN SATKAR YOJANA

**NOW EVERY
WOMAN IN PUNJAB
WILL RECEIVE**

₹1,000

PER MONTH

**WOMEN FROM THE
SC CATEGORY
WILL RECEIVE**

₹1,500

PER MONTH

“ Punjab has set a new benchmark of women empowerment before the entire nation. The ‘Mukh Mantri Mawan-Dhian Satkar Yojana’ proves that if the government’s intentions are honest, every guarantee can be fulfilled. A strong nation can only be built when half of its population becomes economically independent. ”

Bhagwant Singh Mann

Chief Minister, Punjab



Shandar Chaar Saal, Bhagwant Mann De Naal

AS US-BROKERED TALKS ON HOLD

Both Russia and Ukraine claim front-line progress

KYIV: Russian and Ukrainian officials are making contradictory claims of battlefield successes in their 4-year-old war, with Ukraine saying it has pushed Moscow's forces back in some places on the front line but the Kremlin insisting that Russia's invasion of its neighbour is making progress.

At the same time, Russia's almost daily aerial attacks on civilian areas of Ukraine continue. Three powerful glide bombs struck the centre of the eastern Ukrainian city of Sloviansk, killing four people, the head of the Donetsk regional military administration, Vadym Filashkin, said on Tuesday. At least 16 other people, including a 14-year-old girl, were wounded.

Overnight drone strikes on three other Ukrainian cities wounded at least 17 people, including two children, emergency services said on Tuesday.

Ukraine's air force said that it shot down 122 out of 137 drones that Russia launched during the night.

US-brokered talks between Russia and Ukraine are on hold as Washington's attention is



- Highlights
- » Russia daily attacks on civilian areas of Ukraine
 - » Three powerful glide bombs struck the centre of Sloviansk
 - » Overnight drone strikes on three other Ukrainian cities wounded at least 17 people, including two children

Firefighters put out the fire in an multi-storey apartment building following a Russian missile attack in Kharkiv FILE PHOTO

gripped by the Iran war, which has drawn the international spotlight from Ukraine's plight as it strives to hold back Russia's bigger army.

Despite being short of soldiers, Ukrainian forces have recently retaken nearly all the territory of the southeastern

Dnipropetrovsk industrial region during a counteroffensive, driving Russian troops out of more than 400 square kilometres (150 square miles), Maj. Gen. Oleksandr Komarenko said in an interview published Tuesday by local media outlet RBC-Ukraine.

He described the overall situation on the front line as difficult but under control, with the heaviest fighting continuing near Pokrovsk in eastern Ukraine and Oleksandrivka in the south, where he said Russian forces have concentrated their main effort.

Will work with India to further strengthen ties: Nepal's Balen

KATHMANDU: Rastriya Swatantra Party's (RSP) prime ministerial candidate Balendra Shah on Tuesday expressed confidence in further deepening "historic" Nepal-India ties and making them more "outcome-oriented".

The 35-year-old rapper-turned-politician is all set to become Nepal's first Madhesi prime minister and also the Himalayan nation's youngest elected executive head.

Shah made the remarks in a social media post while thanking PM Narendra Modi for his wishes on the party's electoral success. "Thank you for the good wishes honourable Prime Minister Narendra Modi ji," he said in the post. "I express my confidence that we will work together to further strengthen, deepen and make more outcome-oriented the historic, close, and multi-dimensional relations existing between Nepal and India in the coming days," he said.

The RSP, formed in 2022, has won 125 of the 165 seats under direct voting in Nepal's parliamentary polls as vote counting under the first-past-the-post (FPTP) system concluded on Tuesday.

India at UN slams Pakistan over Afghanistan strikes

Terms the attack 'Hypocritical' and 'flagrant violation'

UNITED NATIONS: India has strongly condemned Pakistan's airstrikes on Afghanistan as a "flagrant violation" of international law, saying it is "hypocritical" to invoke Islamic solidarity while carrying out attacks that have killed civilians during Ramadan.

Addressing a Security Council meeting on the situation in Afghanistan on Monday, India's Permanent Representative to the UN Ambassador Harish Parvathaneni reiterated New Delhi's support for the UN Secretary-General's call for compliance with international law, including international humanitarian law, and for ensuring the protection of civilians.

"India strongly condemns the airstrikes on Afghan territory, which are flagrant violations of international law and the UN Charter and the principle of state sovereignty.

"It is hypocritical to espouse high principles of international law and Islamic solidarity on the one hand, while mercilessly carrying out air strikes during the holy month of Ramadan that have killed 185 innocent civilians as of March 6, more than half of whom are women and children," he said.



Representational Image

According to the UN Assistance Mission in Afghanistan (UNAMA), around 55 per cent of the 185 victims were women and children, and more than 100,000 people have been displaced due to the attacks.

Harish noted that UN Secretary General Antonio Guterres' report also expresses deep concern at civilian casualties caused by cross-border armed violence.

India reiterated its support for the Secretary General's call, urging compliance with obligations under international law, including international humanitarian law and ensuring protection of civilians.

Pakistan had launched airstrikes in Afghanistan in late February, resulting in heavy casualties and injuries.

Harish also reiterated India's grave concern on the practice of "trade and transit terrorism" by denial of passage for trade and cynical closure of access for a land locked country. He said UN declarations on Land Locked Developing countries (LLDCs) sound hollow in the face of such actions. "The trade and transit vulnerabilities of LLDCs should not be weaponised. This is a violation of WTO norms and of the UN Charter and international law.

Format C-2

(For political party to publish in website, newspapers, TV)

Declaration about criminal antecedents of candidates set up by the party

(As per the judgment dated 25th September, 2018 of Hon’ble Supreme Court in WP (Civil) No. 536 of 2011 (Public Interest Foundation &Ors. Vs. Union of India &Anr.)

Name of political party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

* Name of Election: BIENNIAL ELECTION TO THE COUNCIL OF STATES TO FILL UP FIVE SEATS FROM WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

1	2	3	4		5		
SL. No.	Name of constituency	Name of candidate	(A) Pending criminal cases		(B) Details about cases of conviction for criminal offences		
			Name of Court, case No. & status of the case(s)	Sections of the Acts concerned & brief description of offence(s)	Name of Court & date(s) of order(s)	Description of offence(s) & punishment imposed	Maximum Punishment Imposed
1	WEST BENGAL	BABUL SUPRIYA BARAL	1. FIR Case No. 129/14. MPS & MLAS Court, Barasat. No Charges Framed. 2. Case No. 84/16. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed 3. FIR Case No. 129. A.C.J.M Alipore Bankshall Court. No Charges Framed 4. Case No. 438/16. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed 5. FIR Case No. 62. MPS & MLAS Court, Barasat. No Charges Framed. 6. FIR Case No. 97/18. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 7. Case No. 95/19. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 8. FIR NGR No. 948/19. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 9. Case No. 171/19. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 10. Case No. 113 of 2019. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 11. FIR Case No. 40/19. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 12. FIR Case No. 32/19. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 13. FIR NGR No. 34/19. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 14. FIR Case No. 347. ACJM, Alipore. No Charges Framed. 15. FIR NGR No. 995/19. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 16. Case No. 150. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman. No Charges Framed. 17. FIR Case No. 78. ACJM Alipore. No Charges Framed. 18. FIR Case No. 31. ACJM Alipore. No Charges Framed	1. 186/143/283 of the Indian Penal Code and 8(B)(II) NH Act 1956. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly and obstruction of public servants in the discharge of their duties 2. 188 of the Indian Penal Code and 32 of the Police Act. Allegations relating to disobedience of an order duly promulgated by a public servant 3. 504 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to intentional insult with intent to provoke a person 4. 166/323/353/355 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to disobedience of law by a public servant. 5. 509 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to the use of words, gestures, or acts intended to insult the modesty of a woman 6. 143/147/149/153A/186/ 188/ 353 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly. 7. 500/504/506/509 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to defamation, intentional insult with intent. 8. 171C/268/427 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to undue influence in connection with an election 9. 143/342/186/353/506 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly. 10. 143/186/283/506 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly and obstruction of public servants in the discharge of their duties 11. 353/186/188/506/120B of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to obstruction and use of criminal force against public servants 12. 143/147/149/153A/186/188/353 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly and rioting by members of a group 13. Information Not Available 14. 341/323/34/354/506/509 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to wrongful restraint and voluntarily causing hurt 15. 171C/500 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to undue influence in connection with an election and defamation 16. 419/506 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to cheating by personation and criminal intimidation 17. 153A/505/120B of the Indian Penal Code and RW 66/43 Information Technology Act. Allegations relating to promoting enmity between different groups and making statements that may incite public mischief, 18. 506 of the Indian Penal Code. Alleged criminal intimidation	N/A	N/A	N/A

*In the case of election to Council of States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of constituency.



WORLD: PG 2

India slams Pakistan over Afghanistan strikes

CITY: PG 5

Delhi govt explores 'Green Budget' to tackle pollution

FILM: PG 14

'I wasn't a very confident dancer'

MONTHS AFTER OPS CHAOS, INDIGO CEO ELBERS QUILTS

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: IndiGo CEO Pieter Elbers resigned on Tuesday, citing personal reasons, and the country's largest airline has relieved him with immediate effect, a development that comes three months after massive operational disruptions triggered widespread public outrage and regulatory actions.

Co-Founder and Managing Director Rahul Bhatia will manage the affairs of IndiGo on an interim basis till a new person is appointed, while citing personal reasons for the decision, he had also requested the airline to waive the notice period.

"With immediate effect, Pieter Elbers will be stepping down as InterGlobe Aviation Limited's (IndiGo) CEO," InterGlobe Aviation said in a release on Tuesday and

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Feels good to join the elite company of Rohit and Dhoni

Suryakumar Yadav

In today's paper

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JAL JEEVAN MISSION

Rural taps till 2028

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Union Cabinet on Tuesday approved the extension of Jal Jeevan Mission up to December 2028 with an enhanced outlay of Rs 8.7 lakh crore for the rural drinking water supply project which will now shift focus from infrastructure creation to service delivery.

The project was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in 2019 to provide safe and adequate drinking water through tap connections to all households in rural India.

The Cabinet decision shifts the focus from only infrastructure creation to citizen-centric service delivery supported by strong local governance and digital monitoring, PM Modi said on X. "The move will strengthen water security, improve health outcomes and empower rural communities, especially our Nari Shakti," he said.

Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw announced the decision at a press conference. "The Cabinet approved the Ministry of Jal Shakti's proposal to restructure and reorient the implementation of the Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) from infrastructure creation to service delivery, supported by drinking water governance and institutional ecosystem for sustainable rural piped potable water supply," he said.

For restructuring JJM, focusing on structural reforms, the Cabinet has approved an enhancement of the total

Continued on P6

LPG SHORTAGE: Pan-India restaurants brace for impact

Govt rejigs gas allocation; LPG, CNG, piped cooking gas get top priority

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The US-Israel war on Iran has disrupted the supply of oil and gas across the Strait of Hormuz, bringing the crisis at the door step of several Indian cities. A government notification prioritising gas supply to domestic units created a situation where restaurants weren't able to order commercial LPG cylinders, causing disruption to services.

As restaurants weighed their options, the government invoked the Essential Commodities Act, prioritising domestic consumption and transport over industry.

As a growing LPG cylinder shortage is causing disruption in restaurants and hotels across several cities, hospitality associations have warned that eateries are struggling to procure commercial LPG cylinders, forcing some establishments to shut operations temporarily. The shortage is being reported from cities like Mumbai, Bengaluru and Kolkata where restaurant bodies say supplies have become irregular over the past few days.

National Restaurant Association of India (NRAI) president Sagar Daryani said that restaurants are already contemplating getting into limited menus or operating at different hours. "If they don't get supplies in 1-2 days then these restaurants will have to shut down and this is largely in cities like Bengaluru, Pune, Mumbai. A lot of panic is being created and obviously this will spread across the country," Daryani said.

Hit hard by the shortage of



Workers load LPG cylinders at a depot following recent price hikes for both domestic and commercial units, in Nagpur, Maharashtra, on Tuesday

GAS CRUNCH

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» National Restaurant Association of India (NRAI) president Sagar Daryani said that restaurants are already contemplating getting into limited menu or operating at different hours

» The oil ministry has constituted a committee to examine supply issues after a sudden shortage of commercial LPG cylinders alarmed the hospitality sector

commercial LPG cylinders, hoteliers' body on Tuesday said a large number of hotels and eateries in Mumbai will have to shut operations in the next two days if the situation is not resolved.

Similar disruptions are also

LPG output up 10%

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: Centre has taken steps to ensure the supply of domestic gas as there is growing concern about the supply of gas from global markets. This was disclosed on Tuesday that the supply of LPG from the refineries in the country has already increased by about 10 per cent.

As per officials the refineries and petrochemical plants have been asked to increase the production of LPG. As a part of these steps, the refineries have been asked to divert the supply of the two key hydrocarbons used in the production of LPG—propane and butane. This is because these two hydrocarbons form the primary component of the production of LPG. Therefore, diverting these two hydrocarbons is expected to give a big boost to the production of LPG.

The supply of LPG from the public sector oil refineries has been increased to cater to the growing demand for LPG.

Continued on P6

Amid the West Asia crisis, the government has revised the priority order for allocating domestically produced natural gas, placing LPG production alongside CNG and piped cooking gas at the top.

Continued on P6

DAY 10: Iran attacks Israel, Gulf countries



A man reacts in front of a destroyed building that housed a branch of Al-Qard Al-Hassan, a non-bank financial institution run by Hezbollah, which was hit by an Israeli airstrike in Dahiyeh, Beirut's southern suburbs, Lebanon, on Tuesday

Trump dials Putin, discusses Iran, Ukraine

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: Iran launched new attacks on Tuesday at Israel and Gulf Arab countries as it kept up pressure on the Middle East in a war started by Israel and the United States that has rattled world markets and shows no signs of a letup.

In Bahrain, authorities said an Iranian attack hit a residential building in the capital, Manama, killing a 29-year-old woman and wounding eight people. Saudi Arabia said it destroyed two drones over its oil-rich eastern region, and Kuwait's National Guard said it shot down six drones.

In the United Arab Emirates, firefighters battled a blaze in the industrial city of Ruwais — home to petrochemical plants — after an Iranian drone strike. No injuries were reported.

Sirens also sounded in Jerusalem, and sounds of explosions could be heard in

NO LET-UP

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Tel Aviv as Israel's defence systems worked to intercept barges from Iran.

At the Pentagon, US Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth warned that

Continued on P6

Bengal SIR: SC orders forming tribunals to hear voter exclusion appeals

'No new mandatory requirement should be introduced without HC CJ approval'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: The Supreme Court on Tuesday directed the constitution of appellate tribunals comprising former High Court Chief Justices and retired High Court judges to hear appeals arising from exclusions during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in West Bengal, and said the Election Commission of India (ECI) must act on the recommendations of the Chief Justice of the Calcutta High Court in implementing key aspects of the process.

The court said no new mandatory requirement should be introduced without the approval of the Chief Justice of the High Court.

A Bench led by Chief Justice Surya Kant said the Chief Justice

of the Calcutta High Court may request former Chief Justices and two or three retired High Court judges, preferably from the Calcutta High Court or neighbouring States, to serve on the appellate bodies. Once their names are recommended, the ECI will notify them as appellate tribunals to hear appeals against decisions taken during the revision exercise. The Chief Justice will decide the composition and number of such benches.

The court also requested the Chief Justice of the Calcutta High Court to determine the honorarium payable to the retired judges who agree to serve on the tribunals, in consultation with the ECI, which will bear the entire cost.

During the hearing, lawyers for the petitioners

Continued on P6

'DIVINE KARMA', SAYS MAHUA MOITRA

Be fair, ignore govt pressure: Oppn tells Speaker Om Birla

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Opposition members in Lok Sabha on Tuesday said that they want Speaker Om Birla to conduct the House proceedings "fairly" and without succumbing to "pressure" from the government.

On the other hand, the ruling NDA strongly defended Birla's conduct, maintaining that he was impartial and treated both sides of the aisle equally in the lower house.

Congress MP Gaurav Gogoi said the Opposition was compelled to bring a resolution for Birla's removal to "save the Constitution", as he accused him of partisan behaviour.

Initiating the debate on the resolution for the removal of Birla from the Speaker's post, Gogoi claimed that the envi-



ronment of Parliament has become such that the LoP is not allowed to speak in the House during the debate on the motion of thanks to the President's address in February because the leadership of the country is "weak".

Giving reasons as to why the Opposition was compelled to bring the resolution, the MP from Assam's Jorhat said, "We stated that in February, when the LoP wanted to

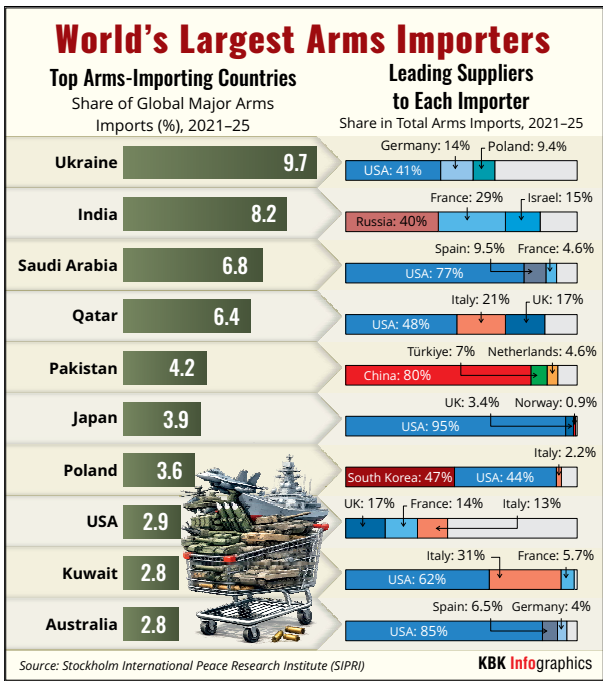
speaking on the motion of thanks to the President's address, he was interrupted 20 times by the Speaker, members of the chairpersons' panel, senior members of the treasury benches. He was interrupted in a premeditated manner."

"The Speaker did not allow the LoP to speak. The LoP was repeatedly interrupted while attempting to place a few critical issues mandatory to be known to the

Continued on P6

RUSSIA REMAINS TOP SUPPLIER

India no. 2 in global arms imports



MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India ranked as the world's second-largest importer of arms and military equipment between 2021 and 2025, with Russia accounting for the largest share of its imports, Swedish think tank SIPRI said in a new report on Monday.

Ukraine, which received 9.7 per cent of all arms transfers in 2021-25 was the world's largest arms importer in that period, the Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI) said.

China dropped out of the top 10 arms importers for the first time since 1991-1995 due to expanded domestic production of its own designs, the think tank noted in its report, "Trends in International Arms Transfers".

The United States supplied 42 per cent of all international arms transfers during 2021-25, up from 36 per cent in 2016-20, it said.

SIPRI REPORT

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» The United States supplied 42 per cent of all international arms transfers during 2021-25, up from 36 per cent in 2016-20

Australia -- ranked among the 10 largest arms importers globally in 2021-25.

The main supplier to the region in 2021-25 was the US, which accounted for 35 per cent of regional arms imports. Russia accounted for another 17 per cent and China for 14 per cent.

"India was the world's second largest arms importer. Its imports decreased marginally (4 per cent) between 2016-20 and 2021-25," the SIPRI said.

"The largest share of Indian arms imports came from Russia, at 40 per cent -- a significantly smaller share than in 2016-20 (51 per cent) and almost half that in 2011-15 (70 per cent)," it said.

India is increasingly turning to Western suppliers, it said.

The report noted that Russia has remained India's main supplier for military hardware. At the same time, it said India has been buying arms from

Continued on P6

FDI curbs eased for border nations

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government on Tuesday eased foreign direct investment (FDI) norms for China and other countries sharing land borders with India by allowing overseas firms having up to 10 per cent shareholding from these nations to invest in the country without mandatory approval. Earlier, overseas firms with shareholdings from these nations owning even a single share had to seek mandatory approval to invest in India in any sector.

However, other conditions of FDI norms, including sectoral caps and entry routes, will be applicable to these investments.

Also, these investments will be subjected to prior reporting of information/details to the DPIIT (department for promotion of industry and internal trade). See P13

Over 9,400 phones snatched in Delhi since January 2024

NEW DELHI: As many as 9,460 mobile phones were seized in the national capital between January 1, 2024 and February 15 this year, Lok Sabha was informed on Tuesday.

Statistically, the data shows one snatching has been reported every two hours in 776 days.

In a written response to a question, Minister of State for Home Affairs Nityanand Rai said, "As reported by Delhi Police, during the period from January 2024 to 15.02.2026, the total number of reported cases of phone snatching and FIRs registered are 9,460 and 9,436, respectively."

He said the total number of mobile phones recovered out of snatched mobiles are 3,950 and out of stolen mobiles are 13,222.

MPOST

FOCUS ON CLEAN ENERGY, MOBILITY AND WASTE MANAGEMENT

Delhi govt explores ‘Green Budget’ to tackle pollution

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Amid growing concerns over pollution, climate change and rapid urbanisation, the Rekha Gupta government is exploring the introduction of a Green Budget, a framework aimed at integrating environmental protection with economic development and long-term urban planning in the national capital.

According to government sources, the proposed initiative seeks to ensure that a significant share of public spending is directed towards programmes that promote environmental sustainability. These include pollution control, clean energy expansion, water conservation, biodiversity protection and other initiatives that support sustainable development.

Explaining the objective behind the move, a government source said, “The idea of a Green Budget is to



“The concept of green or climate budgeting has already been adopted in several countries & by some Indian states

ensure that environmental priorities become an integral part of development planning while maintaining economic growth.” The budgeting framework would also help authorities track investments in environment-related schemes and assess the impact of these initiatives more effectively.

The concept of green or climate budgeting has already

been adopted in several countries and by some Indian states to bring greater transparency and accountability in environmental spending. The Delhi government is currently studying these models to understand how a similar system could be implemented in the capital.

Officials believe the initiative could also open new economic opportunities. Increased

CLOSER LOOK

» The idea of a Green Budget is to ensure that environmental priorities become an integral part of development planning while maintaining economic growth’

» The budgeting framework would also help authorities track investments in environment-related schemes and assess the impact of these initiatives more effectively

investment in sectors such as clean energy, sustainable mobility, waste management and green infrastructure is expected to drive technological innovation and create new employment opportunities.

“A Green Budget is not only about environmental protection; it can also help promote clean technologies, encourage innovation and generate

new jobs in emerging sectors,” another official said.

Delhi has already introduced a number of measures in recent years to address environmental challenges. The government has promoted cleaner transportation through its electric vehicle policy, which aims to reduce emissions from vehicles.

Efforts are also underway to expand solar power generation, encourage rooftop solar installations, strengthen waste management systems and improve water conservation measures. Sources said the government has begun consultations with experts, environmentalists, policymakers and different departments to explore how the Green Budget framework could be implemented effectively.

Green Budget aims to ensure environmentally responsible development while supporting economic growth.

Women medical professionals backbone of healthcare: Gupta

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Highlighting the growing role of women in strengthening India’s healthcare system, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday said women medical professionals form the backbone of the nation’s healthcare sector while addressing the “Women in the Medical Profession (Multi-specialty Meet)” held at Sir Ganga Ram Hospital.

Speaking at the event, attended by senior doctors, medical experts, nurses and women healthcare professionals, Gupta acknowledged the immense contribution of women across different areas of the medical field. “Women’s dedication in the medical field is the backbone of the nation’s healthcare system,” she said.

The Chief Minister noted that women today are playing key roles as doctors, surgeons, researchers, nurses and health specialists. According to her, their work goes far beyond providing treatment, as they also contribute significantly to building a healthier and safer society.



“Women are contributing across the medical field, as doctors, surgeons, researchers, nurses and health specialists. Their compassion, sensitivity and dedication make the practice of medicine more humane,” Gupta said while addressing the gathering.

Emphasising the government’s focus on healthcare, Gupta said the Delhi government remains committed to strengthening healthcare services for women. “The Delhi government is committed to ensuring quality healthcare for every woman through better medical facilities, awareness programmes and expanded healthcare services,” she said.

The Chief Minister also praised Sir Ganga Ram Hospital, describing it as a trusted

healthcare institution that has served patients for decades. She said the hospital has not only provided quality treatment to millions of people but has also made significant contributions to medical education, research and modern healthcare practices.

Gupta further highlighted that the institution has encouraged women professionals in the medical field and created opportunities for them to take on leadership roles. Rekha Gupta said women healthcare professionals significantly improve patient care and inspire future generations, expressing confidence that institutions like Sir Ganga Ram Hospital will continue promoting health awareness and a healthier society.

Delhi to add 200 electric buses to public transport fleet this month

NEW DELHI: Delhi is set to expand its electric public transport network with the addition of 200 new electric buses this month, as the government accelerates efforts to build a cleaner and more efficient mobility system in the national capital.

The announcement came during a review meeting chaired by Delhi Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh with officials of the Transport Department and the Delhi Transport Corporation to assess the progress of electric bus deployment, charging infrastructure and key transport projects.

Officials informed the minister that Delhi currently operates over 4,000 electric buses, making it one of the largest EV bus fleets in the country. With continued procurement and deployment, the fleet is expected to reach 7,500 electric buses by the end of this year, significantly strengthening the city’s clean mobility network.



Speaking during the meeting, Singh said, “Delhi is steadily strengthening its electric bus fleet to build a cleaner, stronger and more efficient public transport system.” He added that expanding the EV fleet remains a priority under the leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, with the aim of providing sustainable and commuter-friendly transport solutions. The meeting also reviewed infrastructure preparedness for electric mobility. Officials said EV charging infrastructure has already been established in 44 bus depots

across the city, while additional charging facilities are being developed in 36 depots under the PM e-Drive Phase I and II initiatives. Meanwhile, the government is planning to develop a new interstate bus terminal in Bhalswa on about 20 acres of reclaimed landfill land, which is expected to improve interstate connectivity in North Delhi. The minister ordered a feasibility study for a DTC depot along UER-II and upgrading Burari depot. Automated testing stations at Nand Nagri and Tehkhand are expected in April.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi’s Education Minister and Janakpuri MLA Ashish Sood on Monday interacted with local traders at a Vyapari Sammelan held in the Janakpuri Assembly constituency, where he discussed development initiatives and assured business owners that the government is committed to addressing their concerns and improving infrastructure in the area.

During the conference, attended by a large number of traders and local residents, Sood said traders form an important pillar of Delhi’s economy and require a supportive environment to expand business activities. “Traders play a very important role in Delhi’s economy, and the government is making every effort to provide better basic infrastructure and a supportive environment so that trade can grow stronger,” he said.

The minister highlighted



Traders raised issues related to parking, sanitation, mkt infra

that development works in the Janakpuri constituency have gained momentum over the past year. He shared details of projects underway in Virender Nagar and Shiv Nagar, aimed at strengthening civic infrastructure for both residents and businesses.

According to Sood, development works worth around Rs.5.18 crore are being undertaken in Virender Nagar. These include laying new sewer lines,

construction of roads and drains, strengthening of water supply lines and installation of nearly 1,999 metres of underground electricity cable to improve power supply.

Similarly, projects worth approximately Rs.5.90 crore are in progress in Shiv Nagar. These works involve construction of sewer lines, improvement of roads and drains, renovation of an MCD school, enhancement of transformer capacity and installation of new street lights.

“The government’s aim is not just to make announcements but to ensure that development works are completed within a fixed timeline so that people receive real benefits,” Sood said.

During the interaction, traders raised issues related to parking, sanitation and market infrastructure. The minister assured them that their concerns would be addressed in coordination with the concerned departments.



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government is set to begin on-ground trials of 22 innovative pollution-control devices across key pollution hotspots in the city as part of its Innovation Challenge aimed at tackling deteriorating air quality.

Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa reviewed preparations for the trial phase on Tuesday and directed officials to ensure that the process remains transparent, scientifically robust and focused on identifying solutions that can deliver measurable reductions in pollution levels.

According to the government, the selected technologies were shortlisted from 284 entries received from across the country. The proposals were evaluated by an expert committee, after which 22 devices were chosen for field testing.

Out of these, 13 solutions focus on reducing vehicular emissions, including vehicle-mounted air purification systems, retrofit emission-control technologies and bio-alkaline exhaust scrubbers designed for buses, trucks and generators. The remaining nine technologies aim to improve ambient air quality and include stationary air-purification systems, dust-suppression units and smog-control devices

meant for open areas, road corridors and industrial or construction zones.

Officials said the Internal Technical Evaluation Committee has finalised testing protocols and deployment plans after several rounds of consultations with innovators. Suitable locations across the capital are being identified for installing static devices, while mobile systems will be tested on vehicles operating in high-pollution areas.

Sirsa said the initiative is aimed at identifying technologies that can produce tangible results and be implemented at scale. “This Innovation Challenge is a mission to find real, measurable solutions that can cut pollution on the ground,” he said.

He added that the government would rely on evidence from the trials to determine which technologies are most effective. “Our benchmark will be which solutions deliver clear and consistent reductions in pollution and can be scaled up quickly,” the minister said.

The Environment Department and the Delhi Pollution Control Committee will monitor the performance of these devices during the trial phase, and the findings will help determine their potential integration into Delhi’s broader clean-air strategy.

Navyug School: NDMC opens butterfly garden

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Tuesday inaugurated a butterfly garden at Navyug School Mandir Marg to promote environmental awareness and biodiversity conservation among students.

The garden, developed under the theme “Vikas Bhi, Virasat Bhi Grow with Plants,” was inaugurated by Sarita Tomar in the presence of Kritika Chaudhary. The initiative aims to serve as a “living classroom,” enabling students to observe butterflies and understand the role of

pollinators in ecosystems.

Speaking at the event, Tomar praised the school’s efforts in promoting environmental education and said such initiatives help students develop a deeper understanding of nature and conservation.

On the occasion, a book titled “Butterfly Garden: Nurturing Future Environmental Stewards,” authored by Rachna Mohan, was also released.

School authorities said the garden would encourage experiential learning and strengthen students’ engagement with biodiversity and sustainable practices.

Data shows high faecal coliform levels in Yamuna

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Fresh water quality data released by the Delhi Pollution Control Committee has raised fresh concerns about pollution in the Yamuna River, with several monitoring points in Delhi recording extremely high levels of faecal coliform and Biological Oxygen Demand (BOD), indicators that suggest untreated sewage is continuing to enter the river.

The reports for January and February, which were uploaded after a delay, show that pollution indicators remain well above the permissible limits at most locations where samples are collected along the river’s stretch through the national capital.

According to the January

assessment, faecal coliform counts touched 350,000 Most Probable Number (MPN) per 100 millilitres at Asgarpur, far exceeding the prescribed limit of 2,500 and the desirable level of 500. At other monitoring points, the counts ranged from 3,300 to 220,000 MPN per 100 ml. Among the eight monitoring locations, Palla was the only site that remained within the permissible range, recording about 2,700 MPN per 100 ml.

The monitoring exercise is carried out at eight locations including Palla, Wazirabad, ISBT Bridge, ITO Bridge, Nizamuddin Bridge, Hindon Cut, Okhla Barrage and Asgarpur. At these sites, the DPCC measures parameters such as BOD, dissolved oxygen, chemical

oxygen demand, pH level and faecal coliform to determine the river’s pollution levels.

The January report also showed worrying levels of BOD, which ranged between 2.5 mg/l and 52 mg/l, even though the standard limit for maintaining acceptable water quality is 3 mg/l. BOD measures the amount of oxygen required by microorganisms to break down organic matter, and higher values indicate greater pollution.

When compared with previous months, the January figures show a rise in pollution levels. In December 2025, faecal coliform levels had reached 92,000 units per 100 ml, increasing from 24,000 in November and 8,000 in October. However, the latest read-

ings are still considerably lower than those recorded in January 2025, when the levels had peaked at nearly 7.9 million units per 100 ml.

The February report indicates a slight improvement but pollution levels remain far above permissible standards. Faecal coliform levels during the month ranged between 1,200 and 110,000 units per 100 ml, while BOD reached 36 mg/l at the ISBT Bridge.

Data showed gaps in sewage treatment, with 13 of 35 STPs failing prescribed norms in January and 12 in February, mainly due to faecal coliform levels. Activists also flagged delays in publishing monitoring reports, stressing the need for regular checks, especially after the monsoon.

PLAN TO SUPPORT 5,000 STARTUPS BY 2035

Delhi pushes industry partnerships, startup growth to build ‘Capital of Innovation’ by ‘47

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Speaking at the Delhi State Annual Session 2025–26 and Business Conference organised by the Confederation of Indian Industry in the national capital, Delhi’s Education Minister Ashish Sood on Monday stressed the need for stronger government-industry collaboration, policy reforms and startup promotion to transform Delhi into a global hub of growth, innovation and partnerships by 2047.

Addressing the session themed “Delhi 2047: Capital of Growth, Innovation & Global Partnerships,” Sood said, “Strong government-industry collaboration is essential to build Delhi as the capital of growth, innovation and global



partnerships by 2047.” The discussion was aligned with the broader national vision of Viksit Bharat.

The minister acknowledged that the business community in Delhi has raised concerns related to infrastructure, policy frameworks, employment generation and availability of land. He said the government is committed to addressing these issues through policy reforms and continued engagement

with industry stakeholders. “The Delhi Government is committed to engaging with industry stakeholders to create future-ready policies and a more enabling environment through deregulation and policy reforms,” Sood said, adding that consistent dialogue with businesses would help strengthen Delhi’s economic growth.

Highlighting steps to boost the startup ecosystem, he said the government plans to support nearly 5,000 startups by 2035 through an upcoming incubation policy. The initiative is expected to involve an investment of around Rs.325 crore over the next five years.

Sood also referred to the recently organised Startup Yuva Festival, where prom-

ising startup ideas received financial assistance. According to him, the government is encouraging entrepreneurship among young people while also working to modernise the curriculum of Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs) so that students acquire skills aligned with industry requirements.

On improving the business environment in Delhi, the minister said reforms are underway to simplify approvals related to Fire NOC processes, labour regulations and licensing requirements in the hospitality sector. Sood stressed government-industry dialogue for economic growth and said 18 lakh students will benefit from smart classrooms, digital libraries and ICT labs in government schools.

Missing Delhi scrap dealer found murdered

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 31-year-old scrap tools dealer from central Delhi who had gone missing after leaving home with Rs 2.5 lakh in cash for business was found murdered in Faridabad, police said on Tuesday.

The victim, identified as Arib, a resident of Delhi Gate, was reported missing at Chandni Mahal police station on March 7 after he failed to return from Faridabad, where he had gone for scrap business dealings. During investigation, police found he was last in contact with Harsh (25) of Karawal Nagar. Harsh was apprehended and led police to Rahul in Aligarh. During questioning, Rahul allegedly confessed that Arib was murdered over a monetary dispute involving another accused, Babu.

FOCUS ON ENERGY SECURITY

Jaishankar discusses West Asia crisis with German, South Korean counterparts

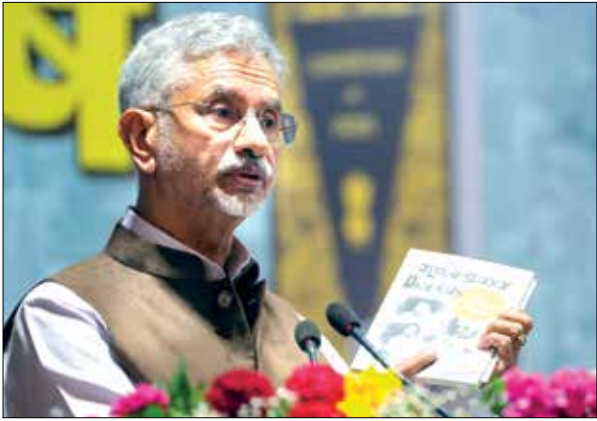
OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: External Affairs minister S Jaishankar on Tuesday spoke to his German and South Korean counterparts as New Delhi ramps up diplomatic efforts to navigate the fallout of the West Asia crisis, especially on the energy supplies.

Global oil and gas prices have surged after Iran virtually blocked the Strait of Hormuz, a narrow shipping lane between the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman, that handles roughly 20 per cent of global oil and LNG (Liquefied Natural Gas).

Following his conversation with German Foreign Minister Johann Wadephul, Jaishankar said the ongoing conflict in West Asia was discussed.

“Exchanged views with FM



External Affairs minister S Jaishankar

@JoWadephul of Germany on the ongoing conflict in West Asia,” he said on social media.

Jaishankar said he and South Korean Foreign Minister Cho Hyun discussed the situation in West Asia, including its implica-

tions on the energy sector. “Discussed advancing our bilateral agenda. As also the situation in West Asia, including its energy implications,” the external affairs minister said. In a post on X, Cho hoped

Highlights

- » Following his conversation with German Foreign Minister Johann Wadephul, Jaishankar said the ongoing conflict in West Asia was discussed
- » Jaishankar said he and South Korean Foreign Minister Cho Hyun discussed the situation in West Asia, including its implications on the energy sector

“Minister Jaishankar agreed and said we should work together to expand strategic economic cooperation between Korea and India, which has significant potential and strong complementarity,” Cho said.

“We also discussed the situation in the Middle East, which is having a major impact on global security and the economy, and agreed to maintain close communication on measures to ensure the safety of our nationals as the situation develops,” he said.

Earlier on Monday, Jaishankar said that Iran had sought India’s permission for three of its ships to dock at Indian ports and the approval was granted the next day, amid tensions in the Indian Ocean region following the sinking of an Iranian warship by the US last week.

Continued from Page 1
Outlay to Rs. 8.69 lakh crore, with a total central assistance of Rs. 3.59 lakh crore as against Rs 2.08 lakh crore approved in 2019-20. A uniform national digital framework called “Sujalam Bharat” shall be instituted, under which every village shall be assigned a unique Sujal Gaon or Service Area ID, digitally mapping the complete drinking water supply system from source to tap.

According to an official statement, a Gram Panchayat shall certify completion of works and declare itself “Har Ghar Jal” only upon confirmation that adequate in-village operation and maintenance mechanisms have been established by the state government.

Recognising that community ownership and participation are critical for operational efficiency and source sustainability, the programme shall promote “Jal Utsav” as an annual, community-led maintenance and review event,

Key Points

- » At present, out of 19.36 crore rural households identified by the States/UTs in the country, around 15.80 crore (81.61 per cent) households are reported to have tap water connections as on date
- » JJM 2.0 would facilitate the certification of all Gram Panchayats as ‘Har Ghar Jal’, by provisioning tap water connection to all the 19.36 crore rural households across the country by December 2028

integrating local cultural ethos while reinforcing collective responsibility for a drinking-water-secure future.

From the baseline of 3.23 crore (17 per cent) rural households with tap water connections in 2019, so far, more than 12.56 crore additional rural households have been provided with tap water connections under JJM, the statement said.

At present, out of 19.36 crore rural households identified by the States/UTs in the country, around 15.80 crore (81.61 per cent) households are reported to have tap water connections as on date.

JJM 2.0 would facilitate the

certification of all Gram Panchayats as ‘Har Ghar Jal’, by provisioning tap water connection to all the 19.36 crore rural households across the country by December 2028 while ensuring adherence to timelines, scheme sustainability, and delivery of citizen-centric water services through Separate MoUs with state/UTs.

The statement said that JJM 2.0 also fosters the vision of Viksit Bharat @2047 with assured 24x7 rural drinking water supply by shifting from an infrastructure-centric approach to a citizen-centric utility-based service delivery approach through structural reforms.

From Page 1

LPG SHORTAGE

This has led to supply crunch for hotels and restaurants which use market priced commercial LPG.

The shortage of commercial LPG has become extremely serious over the past week, with intermittent disruptions escalating into a near complete halt in supply in several regions since Monday, said Shetty, who is also the Spokesperson, Hotel and Restaurant Association (Western India) - HRAWI.

“We are already receiving reports of severe shortages from cities including Mumbai, Pune, Aurangabad and Nagpur, while similar disruptions are being reported in states such as Delhi, Karnataka, Telangana and Andhra Pradesh. If the situation does not improve within the next two days, nearly 50 per cent of hotels and restaurants in Mumbai may be forced to temporarily shut operations depending on the stock of cylinders they currently have,” he cautioned.

This will especially affect international tourists. Also, smaller and medium-sized eateries will be the first to be impacted, as they typically operate with limited reserves, Shetty stated.

He observed that while alternatives such as electric or induction-based cooking are gradually emerging, they are not yet viable for most commercial kitchens that rely on high-intensity, fast-paced cooking methods typical of Indian cuisine.

Meanwhile, the oil ministry has constituted a committee to examine supply issues after a sudden shortage of commercial LPG cylinders alarmed the hospitality sector.

In a letter to Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas Hardeep Singh Puri on Tuesday, NRAI said the restaurant industry continues to face tough challenges to maintain operations because of disruption in supply of commercial LPG.

It urged the government to issue a clarification regarding the supply of commercial LPG for the restaurant industry as an essential service. NRAI also issued an advisory to member restaurants asking them to tweak menus and adopt LPG conservation measures.

Piyush Kankaria, head of the National Restaurant Association of India’s Kolkata chapter, said the city has nearly 5,000 restaurants and a quick survey among members indicated that many establishments are already running out of cooking fuel. “About 40 per cent of restaurants have indicated there will be immediate disruption, while another 30-40 per cent said they can run operations only for a few more days as they have limited stock,” he said.

In Delhi, Joy Singh, co-founder of restaurant chain Raasta, said the situation in the city appears relatively stable compared with some other major cities but it has started exploring alternatives to reduce LPG dependence.

India consumes about 31.3 million tonnes of LPG annually. As much as 87 per cent of this is

in the domestic sector i.e. household kitchens, and the rest in commercial establishments such as hotels and restaurants. Of this total requirement, as much as 62 per cent is met through imports.

The government notification said that domestically produced natural gas will now be supplied on a priority basis to units that use it to produce LPG.

Until now, compressed natural gas (CNG) and piped cooking gas were the two priority sectors to receive domestic natural gas as their raw material. With the gazette notification passed late Monday night, LPG also has been put on the priority list of recipients of natural gas.

Under the revised allocation, requirements of LPG, CNG and piped gas manufacturers will be fully met first before natural gas is supplied to other sectors.

The supply of natural gas to the domestic piped natural gas grid, CNG for transport, and LPG production shall be treated as priority allocation. They would be supplied 100 per cent of their average past six month gas consumption, the notification said. Behind these three sectors is the fertiliser sector in second place, with at least 70 per cent of its past six months demand being met.

At No. 3, gas supply to tea industries, manufacturing and other industrial consumers will be maintained at 80 per cent of their past six-month average gas consumption subject to operational availability, the notification said.

All city gas distribution (CGD) entities supplying gas to industrial and commercial consumers have been placed at No. 4 on the priority list. They must ensure their customers receive 80 per cent of their past six month average gas consumption subject to operational availability. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

LPG output

This is because the supply of LPG has been impacted by the growing tensions in West Asia. This is at a time when there is growing concern about the supply of commercial LPG cylinders used by restaurants.

Further, a three-member special committee is monitoring the scarcity faced by restaurants and other non-domestic users on a case-by-case basis. This committee, consisting of members from IOCL, BPCL, and HPCL, has been set up by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas. At the same time, the government has issued the Natural Gas (Supply Regulation) Order, 2026, under the Essential Commodities Act, to regulate the production, supply, and distribution of gas.

Iran attacks

Tuesday “will be yet again our most intense day of strikes inside Iran: The most fighters, the most bombers, the most strikes, intelligence more refined and better than ever.”

Shortly before the statement, he said, “The last 24 hours have seen Iran fire the lowest amount of missiles they have fired yet.”

Gen. Dan Caine, chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, said US forces hit more than 5,000 targets, and that their three objectives included destruction of Iranian ballistic missile and drone capa-

bility; hitting Iran’s navy to allow movement through the Strait of Hormuz; and hitting “deeper into Iran’s military and industrial base.”

The rhetoric was equally sharp from Tehran. Iran’s parliament speaker, Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf, said on X that Iran was “definitely not looking for a ceasefire.”

“We believe that the aggressor should be punched in the mouth so that he learns a lesson so that he will never think of attacking our beloved Iran again,” he said.

Along with firing missiles and drones at Israel and at American bases in the region, Iran has also been targeting energy infrastructure and traffic through the Strait of Hormuz, a vital waterway for traded oil, sending oil prices soaring.

The attacks appear aimed at generating enough global economic pain to pressure the US and Israel to end their strikes.

Brent crude, the international standard, spiked to nearly USD 120 on Monday before falling back, but was still at around USD 90 a barrel on Tuesday, nearly 24 per cent higher than when the war started on Feb. 28.

Trump, who has previously said that the war could last for a month or longer, sought to downplay growing fears that it could take even longer, saying it was “going to be a short-term excursion.”

Still, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu vowed the strikes on Iran would continue. “Our aim is to bring the Iranian people to cast off the yoke of tyranny, (but) ultimately it depends on them,” Netanyahu said during a meeting with Israel’s hospital and health system leaders.

“There is no doubt that with the actions taken so far, we are breaking their bones.”

Iran has effectively stopped tankers from using the Strait of Hormuz, which connects the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman — the gateway to the Indian Ocean — through which 20 per cent of the world’s oil is carried. Attacks on merchant ships near the strait have killed at least seven sailors, according to the International Maritime Organisation.

In a post on social media, Trump seemed not to acknowledge that, saying that “If Iran does anything that stops the flow of Oil within the Strait of Hormuz, they will be hit by the United States of America TWENTY TIMES HARDER than they have been hit thus far.”

Iran’s paramilitary Revolutionary Guard doubled down, saying it “will not allow the export of even a single litre of oil from the region to the hostile side and its partners until further notice.”

Meanwhile, Amin Nasser, the president and CEO of Saudi Arabia’s oil giant Aramco, said tankers were being rerouted to avoid the Strait of Hormuz, and that its East-West pipeline would reach its full capacity of 7 million barrels a day, being brought to the Red Sea port of Yanbu this week.

As the conflict spread across the region, Israel launched multiple attacks on the militant Hezbollah group in Lebanon, which responded by firing missiles into Israel.

Israel’s military, meanwhile, reiterated a call for all residents of southern Lebanon to evacuate their homes, saying it planned to “operate forcefully” there against Hezbollah.

Since the war began, at least 1,230 people have been killed in

Iran, at least 397 in Lebanon and 11 in Israel, according to officials. A total of seven US service members have been killed.

Meanwhile, President Trump dialled his Russian counterpart Vladimir Putin late Monday night amid global energy disruption caused by American-Israeli strikes on Iran, leading to the virtual closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

According to Kremlin foreign policy aide Yuri Ushakov, the two leaders discussed the conflicts between the US and Iran and between Russia and Ukraine during an hour-long telephonic conversation.

“The conversation focused on the Iran conflict and the bilateral talks between Moscow, Washington and Kyiv aimed at settling the Ukraine conflict. The dialogue between the two presidents was business-like, open and constructive,” Ushakov said.

Briefing the Kremlin pool reporters shortly before midnight, Ushakov said President Putin also shared his thoughts on the ongoing conflict in Iran and briefed Trump on his last week’s conversations with the leaders of the Gulf states and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian.

“Trump, in turn, expressed his opinion about the situation. They had a very substantive discussion on the issue,” Ushakov said.

This was Putin and Trump’s 11th phone conversation and first this year. Last time they had talked in December, Ushakov noted.

In another development, five members of the Iranian women’s soccer team who were in Australia for a tournament when the Iran war began were granted asylum, Home Affairs Minister Tony Burke told reporters in Brisbane.

IndiGo CEO

thanked him for his contribution and service, as well as wished him well in his future endeavours.

In his resignation letter, Elbers, a Dutch national, said it has been both an honour and a privilege to serve as the CEO for the past few years, since September 2022, and being a part of the great IndiGo family, “it’s a beautiful growth story and the steps we have made together in this.”

“If the company so desires, obviously, I will be available for any handover or transition otherwise. I would like to thank you personally, and IndiGo’s Board, for the support extended to me,” he said.

The resignation comes three months after the airline faced massive operational disruptions, especially between December 3 and 5 last year -- a period during which 2,507 flights were cancelled, and 1,852 flights were delayed, impacting over 3 lakh passengers at airports across the country.

In January, aviation watchdog DGCA slapped penalties totalling Rs 22.20 crore for the massive flight disruptions in December, and had warned Elbers and two other senior executives for non-compliance.

The regulator had also directed the airline to furnish a Rs 50-crore bank guarantee to ensure long-term systemic corrections.

According to the airline, Bhatia shall, in the interim, assume management of the affairs of the airline until such time that the

Company announces the arrival of a new leader, which is expected in short order.

In the release on Tuesday, Bhatia said that having founded and nurtured IndiGo for twenty-two years, “I feel a deep sense of personal commitment and responsibility towards our nation, and towards the airline’s customers, employees, shareholders and all other stakeholders.”

“While placing culture, service excellence and stakeholder trust at the forefront of its operations, IndiGo will continue to sharpen its strategic focus on serving India and her people with an airline that is professionally managed, operationally reliable and globally respected,” he said in the release.

Bengal SIR

raised concerns about the absence of an independent appellate mechanism for persons whose claims are rejected by judicial officers adjudicating objections in the revision process. Another issue raised was the publication of supplementary lists relating to objections that have already been disposed of.

The court said the parties may approach the Chief Justice of the Calcutta High Court on this question and clarified that the ECI should act in accordance with the Chief Justice’s recommendation.

The Bench noted a communication from the Chief Justice stating that 10.16 lakh objections had been disposed of as of the evening of March 9. About 500 judicial officers from West Bengal and nearly 200 from Odisha and Jharkhand have been deployed to handle the exercise.

Around 700 login IDs had been created by March 8 to facilitate deployment and redeployment of officers, particularly in sensitive districts. However, the court was informed that judicial officers were facing certain logistical and technical difficulties.

The court also asked the poll body to promptly resolve technical disruptions in the portal and ensure that additional login IDs are created immediately whenever required by judicial officers. The court further directed the state government to provide all necessary facilities for the exercise.

Meanwhile, TMC national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee called the SC order a victory of

Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee’s constant struggle and the party’s relentless fight.

Om Birla

House and the people of the country,” Gogoi said.

He pointed out that Gandhi wanted to speak about former army chief MM Naravane’s remarks in his unreleased book, in which he reportedly talked about taking direction from the political leadership and the country’s “mukhiya” told him “Jo uchit samjho wahi karo” (Do what you feel is right).

At this point, Jagdambika Pal, who was in the chair, urged Gogoi to stick to the reasons for bringing the resolution against Birla.

Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju intervened, saying this was a discussion on the Speaker, and if the opposition is talking of other issues, they

should not interrupt when “we reply”.

Responding to Gogoi’s assertion that Rahul Gandhi was not allowed to speak in the House, Rijiju said, “That day I was upset for the fact that the Opposition MP said that ‘I do not need permission from anyone to speak in Parliament.’ This is on record.”

Taking further jibes at the Opposition MPs amid sloganeering, Rijiju said he has “no cure” if someone believes themselves to be “above the speaker” in the House.

Gaurav Gogoi took a swipe at Rijiju: “In future when there will be research on parliamentary records and transcripts are looked at, statistics will tell that Kiren Rijiju was the parliamentary affairs minister, who interrupted the Opposition the most.”

Coming to Rijiju’s defence, Union Home Minister Amit Shah asserted that such interruptions are only necessary when someone doesn’t adhere to the parliamentary rules. Shah then quipped that it is true that Rijiju has interrupted the most, but there has never been an opposition like the current one.

DMK leader T R Baalu, praised Birla as a “gentleman” but lamented his “harsh” steps against the opposition, prompting the ruling alliance to claim that the speaker had acted only to check their “anarchic” behaviour. Baalu said he has great personal regard for the speaker but wants him to take corrective steps in his conduct.

“He is such a gentleman, but I don’t know what went wrong with him. He has suspended so many MPs in the last seven years. But why does he have to take such harsh steps? Our duty is to see that some corrective measures are taken. I want to impress upon the speaker to act fairly,” he said.

Describing the no-confidence motion nothing but an attempt to keep the Speaker under pressure, JD-U leader and Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh said when the custodian of the House tries to control certain behaviours of some members, including ruling party members and ministers, all accept that.

“To maintain the decorum and dignity of the House, the Speaker has to control unruly members. This is nothing wrong,” he said.

The minister alleged that more than half of the time, the opposition members shout and stage protests in the House.

Shiv Sena (UBT) member Arvind Sawant said Birla is a “gentleman” and they respect him, but there is “pressure” on him to act against the opposition.

Sawant said the House should function within rules and regulations as this is the highest temple of democracy. He also questioned why no deputy speaker has been appointed so far.

Trinamool Congress MP Mahua Moitra described as “divine karma” that she was supporting a motion to remove Birla as Lok Sabha Speaker from where she was “wrongly” expelled in 2023.

In her explosive speech, she also said the current speaker has set “less than graceful benchmarks” while presiding over the House and accused the ruling party of turning Parliament into a “circus of democracy”.

She said on the past three occasions when a resolution to remove the speaker came up before the House, there were

deputy speakers to preside the House.

But now there is no deputy speaker for years and a panel of presiding officers were running the House during the crucial issue on Tuesday.

Moitra alleged that a rule which allows the speaker to suspend MPs without a formal resolution in case of grave misconduct has been abused by the current speaker, which is the “very antithesis of democracy.”

“It is all that democracy should not be. In December 2023, Birla ji ordered the largest mass suspension in the history of Indian Parliament, suspending 100 opposition MPs. This one episode alone accounted for over 40 per cent of all Lok Sabha suspensions since 2004,” she claimed.

Rahul’s sister and fellow MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra reacted after Rijiju ended his speech. She said: “They are unable to digest what the Leader of Opposition (Rahul) says, because in the last 12 years (of Narendra Modi as PM), he is the only one who has refused to bow.”

She added, “They (BJP-led NDA government’s MPs) say I keep smiling when they speak. I smile, I laugh because they are suddenly praising Jawaharlal Nehru — whom they otherwise abuse — for his speech when a motion was brought against the LS Speaker of the time (in the 1950s).” Rijiju had asked the Congress-led Opposition to “remember at least” what Nehru said — referring to his defence of the then Speaker GV Mavalankar.

TDP member Lavu Srikrishna Devarayalu said Birla has given maximum time to the new members and productivity in the Lok Sabha was highest under him. He claimed that the no-confidence motion was brought “not to succeed but to create spectacular headlines”. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Global arms

France and Israel as well. “Arms imports by Pakistan grew by 66 per cent between 2016-20 and 2021-25. China supplied 80 per cent of Pakistan’s arms imports in 2021-25, up from 73 per cent in 2016-20,” the report noted.

The US has further cemented its dominance as an arms supplier, even in an increasingly multipolar world, said Pieter Wezeman, Senior Researcher with the SIPRI Arms Transfers Programme.

For importers, US arms offer advanced capabilities and a way of fostering good relations, he said.

“While tensions and conflicts in Asia and Oceania and the Middle East continue to drive large-scale arms imports, the sharp increase in arms flows to European states pushed global arms transfers up almost 10 per cent,” said Mathew George, Director of the SIPRI Arms Transfers Programme. Overall, the report said the volume of major arms transferred between states increased by 9.2 per cent between 2016-2020 and 2021-2025.

“States in Europe more than tripled their arms imports, making it the biggest recipient region. Total exports by the United States, the world’s largest supplier of arms, increased by 27 per cent. This included a 217 per cent increase in US arms exports to Europe,” it said. WITH AGENCY INPUTS



सशक्त नारी
झारखण्ड की
आर्थिक प्रगति का आधार...

मुख्यमंत्री मंईयां सम्मान योजना

18 से 50 वर्ष की पात्र महिलाओं को
हर महीने ₹2,500 की आर्थिक सहायता

प्रति वर्ष कुल **₹30,000**

सर्वजन पेंशन योजना

अब महिलाओं को वृद्धावस्था पेंशन
के लिए 60 वर्ष का इंतजार नहीं करना होगा

**50 वर्ष से ऊपर आयु की सभी वर्ग की
महिलाएं पेंशन की हकदार**

सावित्रीबाई फुले किशोरी समृद्धि योजना

बालिका शिक्षा को बढ़ावा देने और बाल विवाह
रोकने के लिए ₹40,000 तक की कुल सहायता

**कक्षा 8वीं से लेकर 18-19 वर्ष की आयु तक
विभिन्न चरणों में प्रोत्साहन राशि**

फूलो-झानो आशीर्वाद अभियान

हड़िया-शराब की बिक्री और निर्माण कार्य में लगी
महिलाओं को सम्मानजनक स्वरोजगार

शुरु करने के लिए **₹50,000 तक का ब्याज मुक्त ऋण**

...नारी शक्ति
के साथ चल रही
हेमन्त सरकार

स्वरोजगार से स्वावलंबन

झारखण्ड की दीदियां अब खुद का भविष्य
लिख रही हैं, 2.80 लाख से अधिक
स्वयं सहायता समूह बैंकों से जुड़े।

**₹17,374 करोड़ का सीधा ऋण
वितरण, लाखों परिवारों के
जीवन में आई समृद्धि**

स्वस्थ पीढ़ी के लिए मातृत्व अवकाश

संविदा (अनुबंध/कॉन्ट्रैक्ट) के आधार पर
नियुक्त महिला कर्मचारियों को

**180 दिनों का मातृत्व अवकाश
(maternity leave) देने का महत्वपूर्ण फैसला**

ग्रामीण उत्पाद की पहचान पलाश मार्ट

सखी मंडल की दीदियों द्वारा बनाए गए उत्कृष्ट उत्पादों को
'पलाश' ब्रांड के तहत पहचान और बाजार

कला को सम्मान आदिवा ब्रांड

झारखण्ड की ग्रामीण कला, मेहनत और
महिला प्रतिभाओं को नई पहचान देने का मजबूत माध्यम
**ग्रामीण उद्यमिता, महिला स्वावलंबन और
मजबूत ग्रामीण अर्थव्यवस्था का प्रयास**

हेमन्त सोरेन
मुख्यमंत्री, झारखण्ड

India actively promoting AVGC sector: Modi

PM Modi encouraged educational institutions to strengthen industry collaboration & research-driven learning

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi has emphasised that India is actively promoting the Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming and Comics (AVGC) sector as part of the country's transition towards an innovation-driven economy.

Inaugurating a webinar, the Prime Minister encouraged educational institutions to strengthen industry collaboration and research-driven learning so that campuses evolve into centres of innovation and industry engagement, enabling students to gain real-world exposure and strengthening the national skill ecosystem.

The webinar series was inaugurated by Prime Minister Modi, who emphasised that India is actively promoting the AVGC sector as part of the country's



Prime Minister Narendra Modi

transition towards an innovation-driven economy, an official release said.

Speaking at the event, Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw highlighted that the government has established the Indian Institute of Creative Technologies (IICT) on the lines of premier institutions like IIT, IIM and AIIMS.

Highlights

- » Vaishnaw highlighted that the government has established the Indian Institute of Creative Technologies (IICT) on the lines of premier institutions like IIT, IIM and AIIMS
- » The institute includes high-tech model laboratories that are considered among the best globally, comparable to leading facilities in the world

The institute includes high-tech model laboratories that are considered among the best globally, comparable to leading facilities in the world.

He said the institute will provide high-quality education and professional training to young people in emerging areas of the creative, media and technology sectors.

Vaishnaw also noted that Doordarshan has launched a "Creators' Corner", providing content creators with an opportunity to showcase their work, earn revenue and reach audiences across the country as well as globally.

In the closing session of the post-budget webinar, the I&B minister emphasised the grow-

ing importance of the creator economy in providing a democratic platform for citizens to showcase India's vibrant culture and creativity.

He highlighted the role of technology in transforming the media and entertainment sector and noted that the expertise of the Indian Institute of Creative Technologies (IICT) will be leveraged to support the establishment of Content Creator Labs across the country.

The Ministry of Information & Broadcasting (MIB) organised a break-out session on "AVGC Content Creator Labs in Schools and Colleges" as part of the post-budget webinar titled "Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas - Fulfilling Aspirations of People: Education, Skills and University Townships" on Monday.

The session deliberated on the implementation roadmap

for establishing AVGC Content Creator Labs (CCLs) in 15,000 secondary schools and 500 higher educational institutions, as announced in the Union Budget 2026-27.

The session also featured a keynote address by Sanjay Jaju, Secretary, Ministry of I&B, who highlighted the importance of building a robust ecosystem to nurture creative talent and position India as a global leader in the AVGC sector.

During the deliberations, participants emphasised that the establishment of content creator labs in schools and colleges will create structured pathways for students to explore careers in animation, gaming, VFX and digital storytelling, in line with the National Education Policy (NEP) and its focus on multidisciplinary learning, creativity and design thinking.

'WANTS TO DEFAME INDIA' BJP: Rahul Gandhi architect, designer of AI Summit protest

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The BJP on Tuesday called Congress leader Rahul Gandhi the "architect and designer" of protests meant to "embarrass" the country during the recently held World AI Summit and accused him of attempting to demean and defame India.

Addressing a press conference here, BJP MP and national spokesperson Sambit Patra referred to the protest by Youth Congress members during the international conference in Delhi and alleged it was part of a planned effort.

"At that time, we had said very clearly that it was a 'topless, brainless and shameless protest by the Congress party,'" he said, claiming that the demonstration was not spontaneous but a "well-designed act".

"This was not a coincidence but an experiment. We had even said that the architect and designer of this act was Rahul Gandhi himself, and that the design was prepared at his residence," the BJP leader alleged.

Referring to Gandhi's remarks about the AI Summit during a party meeting on Monday, he claimed the Congress leader had effectively admitted his responsibility.

"Yesterday, Rahul Gandhi himself said, 'Haan, humne kaam kar diya' (Yes, we got the job done). The country could see a Mir Jafar-like smile on his face when he claimed they had 'finished' the World AI Summit happening in India," Patra said.

Mir Jafar, a historical figure, is remembered as the commander of the Bengali army under Siraj ud-Daulah and for betraying the leader during the Battle of Plassey.



Rahul Gandhi

The BJP leader alleged that Gandhi appeared pleased at India being embarrassed internationally. "Only a traitor feels happy seeing his own country falter. Yesterday, it was proved that Gandhi was the architect, the designer and the one in the driving seat of demeaning and defaming India," he said.

Drawing a distinction between "hooliganism and leadership", the BJP leader further said that engaging in such behaviour would not make someone a leader. "The way he presented it was surprising. It looked like the kind of quarrel seen among schoolchildren, yet it was projected as a protest against one's own country," Patra said.

He further claimed that Gandhi had repeatedly made statements abroad suggesting that India's democracy was in danger.

"This is part of a well-thought-out design to demean the country," the MP said.

However, the BJP leader asserted that such attempts would not succeed. "Rahul Gandhi may try a thousand times to defame the country, but India will not bow down. The country will only move forward," he said.

Centre promises quicker medicine delivery for CGHS pensioners in J&K

AAISHA SABIR

NEW DELHI: Union minister Jitendra Singh on Monday said that active engagement of senior citizens and pensioners' associations was helping the government refine welfare systems and improve service delivery, as representatives from across the country raised issues affecting retirees during the 35th meeting of the Standing Committee of Voluntary Agencies (SCOVA).

Among the concerns flagged at the meeting was the delay in the supply of medicines through the Central Government Health Scheme (CGHS) wellness centres in Jammu and Kashmir. Pensioners' representatives said medicines prescribed at the centres often take several days to reach empanelled chemists, leaving elderly beneficiaries without timely access to treatment.

According to the Central Government Pensioners' Welfare Association of J&K, the supply chain between wellness centres and chemists currently takes at least five days, creating hardship for thousands of pensioners who depend on the scheme for regular

medication.

Compounding the problem, empanelled chemists sometimes temporarily shut their shops due to relocation or other logistical issues. "The chemist is going on shifting shops and closing down for 10 days. It affects pensioners and people who depend on these medicines," a representative said during the discussion.

The issue was raised in the context of broader concerns about the availability of medicine and the functioning of wellness centres under the CGHS framework. Pensioners' groups from Jammu and Srinagar had earlier flagged delays in medicine supply and staff shortages at the centres as key obstacles to accessing healthcare.

Responding to the concerns, Sateesh YH, Director of the Central Government Health Scheme (CGHS), said the government had revised the tender conditions for medicine suppliers. Under the new system, which will take effect from April 1, medicines must be supplied within two days of prescription; if that deadline is missed, suppliers will be required to deliver the medicines directly to the beneficiary's home.

'Over 8 cr women screened for cervical cancer as of Feb 17'

NEW DELHI: The nationwide Human Papillomavirus (HPV) vaccination campaign targeting eligible girls aged 14 is underway at designated government facilities, Minister of State for Health Prataprao Jadhav told the Rajya Sabha on Tuesday.

"The nationwide HPV vaccination campaign is running, targeting eligible girls aged 14 at designated government facilities such as Ayushman Aarogya Mandir (AAM), primary health centres (PHCs), community health centres (CHCs), sub-district hospitals (SDHs), district hospitals (DHs) and government medical colleges and hospitals (GMCHs)," the minister added.

FOR ACADEMIC YEAR 2025-26 Govt to RS: 43 new medical colleges established, 11,682 MBBS seats approved

NEW DELHI: Minister of State for Health Anupriya Patel told the Rajya Sabha on Tuesday that 43 new medical colleges have been established across the country for the academic year 2025-26.

As informed by the National Medical Commission (NMC), the government has approved 11,682 MBBS seats and 8,967 postgraduate (PG) seats, [including AIIMS and Institutes of National Importance (INIs)] across the country for the same academic year, Patel said in a written reply.

The NMC invites online applications every year from medical colleges and institutions across the country for the establishment of new medical colleges and for the increase

of undergraduate (UG) and PG seats.

Further, letter of permission (LoP) or letter of disapproval (LoD) is issued after following due process of scrutiny and assessment in accordance with the provisions of the Establishment of Medical Institutions, Assessment and Rating Regulations, 2023, Minimum Standard Requirement for Undergraduate courses (UGMSR), 2023, the Minimum Standard Requirement for Postgraduate courses (PGMSR), 2023, and other relevant norms and guidelines issued by the NMC from time to time.

The Union Health Ministry administers a centrally sponsored scheme (CSS) for

"Establishment of new medical colleges attached with existing district/referral hospitals" with preference to underserved areas and aspirational districts, where there is no existing government or private medical college with fund sharing between the Centre and state governments in the ratio of 90:10 for North Eastern and special category states and 60:40 for others, Patel explained.

Under the scheme, 157 medical colleges have been approved in three phases with a total approved cost of Rs 41,332.41 crore. Out of the central share of Rs 26,715.84 crores, an amount of Rs 23,246.10 crore has been released so far, Patel said.

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida - 201301 (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

- 23/GM(E/M)/SM(E/M)/-I/E.T./2025-26, Strengthening of Street Light & Providing Lighting arrangement in Park Sector-138, Noida. Cost Rs. 24.89 Lacs.
- 16/GM(E&M)/S.M./E/M-III/25-26, Annual Maintenance and Servicing of 06 Nos DG Set for Main Administrative Building and Indira Kala Kandra, Sector-06, Noida. Cost Rs. 25.04 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date:- 24.03.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- 25.03.2026 at 11.00 AM.

Office: General Manager (E&M)
Sector-5 NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd Office: Plot No 10, Pagh Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana India
CIN U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Gurgaon Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)
HOD- C&I & IT, GATPL, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of:
1. Tender Enquiry No 134/GATPL/CNI/60001857 dated 10/03/2026
"Design verification, supply, installation, integration, testing and commissioning of CBMS Gas Analyser"
Area of 2x270 MW Thermal Power Plant (GATPL), Goindwal Sahib.
at 2x270 MW Gurgaon Thermal Plant (GATPL), Goindwal Sahib, Distt: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specification.
For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 10/03/2026 from 17.00 Hrs onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>
GATPL-27/26 PR-Advt. No :- 1079/12/2025-26/9279

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Akash @ Niranjan**, S/o: Sanjay Singh, R/o: H.No. A-223, Shahid Bhagat Singh Colony, Karala, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 617/2020 U/s 379/356/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Paschim Vihar West, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Akash @ Niranjan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Akash @ Niranjan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Akash @ Niranjan** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 617/2020 U/s 379/356/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Paschim Vihar West, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.04.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Ankit Karan Singh
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-08 (West)
Room No. 30, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/2877/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: The Uttar Pradesh government has asked all MLAs to submit proposals for development works worth up to Rs 5 crore in their constituencies, with Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath directing officials to expedite the process and ensure timely implementation.

According to official information, the chief minister has sought detailed proposals for development projects from legislators and asked that they be sent to the Chief Minister's Office within one week. The

initiative is aimed at accelerating local development and addressing region-specific needs across the state.

The chief minister issued the directions while interacting with MLAs and members of the Legislative Council through a video conference from his official residence. According to sources, the interaction lasted about 30 minutes during which he asked legislators to remain present in their constituencies, address public grievances and supervise development works on the ground.

During the interaction, the

Closer Look

- » The initiative is aimed at accelerating local development and addressing region-specific needs across the

state

- » Suggested projects include construction of roads, community centres, barat ghars, bridges and convention centres

chief minister suggested several types of projects that legislators can propose for their constituencies. These include construction of roads, community centres, barat ghars, bridges and convention centres. MLAs have also been asked to suggest projects related to installation of street

lights, construction of public toilets and other facilities that improve civic infrastructure.

District Magistrates have been directed to examine the proposals submitted by the legislators and ensure that the required funds are released after due scrutiny. Officials said the administration will

prioritise projects that can bring visible improvements in local infrastructure and public services.

The chief minister has also instructed MLAs to remain active in their constituencies and closely monitor the progress of development works. Legislators have been asked to coordinate with district officials to ensure that projects are executed on time and in accordance with approved plans.

In a first, the state government has also invited proposals from members of the Legislative Council. Officials said MLCs have been asked

to identify development projects in areas they represent and send their recommendations to the government for consideration.

Government sources said the move is intended to strengthen grassroots development and improve coordination between elected representatives and the administration. By involving both MLAs and MLCs in proposing projects, the state government aims to broaden participation in development planning and ensure that local priorities are reflected in government initiatives.

TWO DECADES AFTER INDIA'S OCEAN DESALINATION EXPERIMENT Lakshadweep's water lifeline seeks a second phase

Key Points

- » During a visit to Kavaratti, Jitendra Singh reviewed the functioning of the desalination facility
- » For many residents, the change has been visible in everyday life
- » Officials said the review focused on improving the efficiency and durability of the existing plant while exploring technological upgrades



AAISHA SABIR

KAVARATTI: Nearly two decades after India pioneered an ocean-based desalination experiment in Lakshadweep, the technology that eased chronic drinking water shortages across the islands is entering a new phase of technological renewal.

During a visit to Kavaratti on March 6, Union Minister for Earth Sciences Jitendra Singh reviewed the functioning of the desalination facility and ongoing efforts to strengthen the ageing infrastructure that has been operating since 2005.

For many residents, the change has been visible in everyday life. Kadeeshomma, an 80-year-old resident of Kavaratti who spent her life on the island, recalls a time when access to freshwater was uncertain. A former government school teacher, she says the desalination plant transformed daily life.

"Water now flows from the tap regularly, but that was not always the case. The desalination plant has been a game

changer for us," she said, adding that with the island's population increasing, she remains hopeful that the government will continue strengthening water infrastructure.

Officials said the review focused on improving the efficiency and durability of the existing plant while exploring technological upgrades.

The Ministry is also moving ahead with a new ocean thermal energy conversion (OTEC)-powered desalination facility at Kavaratti, a project that aims to simultaneously generate electricity and freshwater using the ocean's natural thermal gradient.

The present system is based on a process called low-temperature thermal desalination (LTTD), an indigenous technology developed by the National Institute of Ocean Technology under the Ministry of Earth Sciences. The method converts seawater into potable water by utilising the natural temperature difference between warm surface water and colder deep-ocean water.

In the process, warm seawater is introduced into a low-pressure chamber, where it rapidly evaporates. Cold seawater drawn from depths of nearly 350-400 metres is then circulated through a condenser system, cooling the vapour and turning it into fresh water. The temperature contrast between surface waters, usually around 28°C, and much colder deep-sea water enables desalination without chemical additives or high-pressure membranes.

Engineers said the cold seawater intake is connected to the shore via a subsea pipeline that stretches several hundred metres, with pumps regulating the circulation required for continuous operation. When the Kavaratti plant was commissioned, it was designed to produce nearly 1 lakh litres of drinking water daily.

Over the years, however, prolonged exposure to harsh marine conditions and ageing equipment have reduced its output. Officials indicated that the plant now produces roughly 80,000 litres of potable water a day.



EDITORIAL

AN IN'VISIBLE' CRISIS

India's public health conversation has long been dominated by visible crises—infectious diseases, malnutrition, maternal mortality and outbreaks that demand urgent policy responses. Yet running parallel to these well-recognised challenges is a quieter but equally consequential crisis: the rising burden of mental illness. Today, the scale of the problem is impossible to ignore. Experts estimate that one in seven Indians lives with some form of mental health disorder, a staggering number that cuts across age groups, regions and socio-economic groups. Even more troubling is the enormous treatment gap. In several states, between 70 and 90 per cent of those suffering from mental health conditions receive little or no professional care, either because services are unavailable, specialists are scarce, or stigma discourages people from seeking help. In such a context, the Union Budget's announcement to establish a second National Institute of Mental Health and Neuro Sciences (NIMHANS) in North India is an important policy signal. It reflects a growing recognition that India's mental health infrastructure must expand if it is to address the scale of the challenge. The original NIMHANS in Bengaluru has, over the decades, evolved into one of the country's most respected centres for neuroscience, psychiatry and mental health research. Its influence extends far beyond patient care, shaping specialist training, clinical standards and national policy discussions. Replicating such an institution is therefore not merely a bureaucratic expansion of infrastructure. It represents an acknowledgement that mental health is no longer a peripheral concern within the healthcare system but a central public health priority that demands sustained attention and investment.

The importance of strengthening mental healthcare becomes even clearer when seen in the broader context of India's evolving disease burden. Non-communicable diseases now account for more than 60 per cent of deaths in the country, and mental and neurological disorders contribute significantly to disability-adjusted life years (DALYs). Depression, anxiety, substance dependence and stress-related conditions are increasingly intertwined with chronic illnesses such as diabetes, hypertension and cardiovascular disease. When mental health conditions remain untreated, they worsen the outcomes of these physical illnesses and impose high economic costs through lost productivity, family distress and long-term disability. Yet despite the growing burden, mental health services remain unevenly distributed across the country. While a handful of institutions provide high-quality care and research, vast regions still lack access to advanced neuro-psychiatric facilities. North India in particular faces a shortage of tertiary-level services, especially in specialised areas such as neuroimaging, neurocritical care and advanced neurological treatment. For millions of patients, accessing such services often requires travelling to distant cities, incurring financial strain and delaying treatment that could prevent further deterioration. Establishing NIMHANS-2, therefore, has the potential to correct a long-standing regional imbalance. More importantly, it could expand the country's capacity to train psychiatrists, neurologists, psychologists and other mental health professionals—an area where India faces an acute shortage. However, infrastructure alone will not close the treatment gap. The deeper challenge lies in ensuring that knowledge and expertise generated in premier institutions reach district hospitals and primary healthcare systems. Experts have therefore emphasised the need for a hub-and-spoke model, where centres of excellence provide specialist guidance, tele-consultation support and training to smaller hospitals and community-level facilities. If implemented effectively, such a system could extend specialised mental health care to rural and underserved regions without forcing patients to travel long distances.

Equally significant is the proposal to establish a National Brain-Mind Cloud Network under the National Health Mission, linking institutions such as AIIMS, state medical colleges and primary healthcare centres through digital platforms. In an era where technology increasingly shapes healthcare delivery, such integration could transform the reach of mental health services. Unified digital health records, AI-based screening tools and tele-neuro-psychiatric hubs could enable early diagnosis and specialist consultations even in districts that lack trained professionals. India's Tele-MANAS programme, which offers tele-mental health support through call centres and digital platforms, has already demonstrated the potential of technology to bridge geographical barriers. Integrating such initiatives with major neuroscience institutions could create a nationwide network capable of providing counselling, diagnosis and follow-up care to millions of people who currently remain outside the formal healthcare system. This is particularly important for underserved regions such as the northeastern states and remote rural districts, where specialist manpower and infrastructure remain limited. Yet technology and institutional expansion alone cannot address the deeper challenge. For decades, mental illness in India has remained hidden behind stigma, social silence and fragmented policy attention. Many families still hesitate to seek professional help, treating psychological distress as a private or moral issue rather than a medical condition. Addressing this barrier will require sustained public awareness, community-level engagement and the integration of mental health services within primary healthcare systems. Initiatives aligned with the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and the ABHA ID ecosystem can strengthen coordination within the healthcare system, but the ultimate test of success will be whether these reforms reduce the treatment gap and encourage people to seek help without fear or shame. India's aspirations for economic growth, social stability and demographic advantage cannot be realised if the psychological well-being of its citizens remains neglected. Recognising mental health as a national priority must therefore evolve into a sustained commitment that expands care systems, strengthens institutions and ensures that no individual is left to struggle with mental illness in silence.

BHARAT KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS THE CHAIRPERSON, BHARAT KI SOCH

True leadership lies not in dominance but in awakening others — a lesson embodied by Jambavan't's quiet influence in the Ramayana

WAR CALCULUS



MOUSUMI ROY

THE WRITER WRITES ABOUT POLITICS, MATERIAL CULTURE, AND ECONOMIC HISTORY

Wars launched with confident predictions often end with consequences far beyond what their architects intended

Leadership through Ancient Wisdom

The Ramayana's Jambavan't offers a timeless example of mentorship, restraint and insight that remains relevant to modern institutions and organisations

"Enthusiasm is a powerful force; there is no strength greater than resolve. For one who acts with determination, nothing in the world is difficult to attain."
- Valmiki Ramayana, Kishkindha Kanda, Sarga 1, Verse 120-121

In a rapidly changing business environment marked by uncertainty and constant transformation, leadership is called upon to preserve direction, restore confidence and awaken excellence in others. Leaders today are expected to be innovative yet prudent, decisive yet compassionate, flexible yet grounded in principle. The pressures of global competition, technological acceleration and social expectations demand qualities that extend beyond technical competence. Ancient Indian wisdom offers enduring portraits of such leadership, presenting figures whose principles strengthen the foundations of institutional integrity. Among them stands Jambavan't, the elder of the vanara host in the Ramayana, whose influence appears subtle in form yet decisive in its impact. His story reminds us that leadership wisdom is as potent as power, and that the quiet strength of judgment often determines whether institutions advance with clarity or falter in moments of uncertainty.

Unlike many heroes of the epic era who are remembered for dramatic action or displays of power, Jambavan't occupies a quiet yet indispensable role. Described as the king of the bears (rikshas) and one of the oldest beings in the Ramayana, he is revered not for dominance but for wisdom accumulated over time. Created in the earliest ages, he is said to have lived through several cosmic epochs, giving him a perspective shaped by long memory and experience. This reveals an important leadership lesson. Experience is a form of strategic capital. Veterans provide institutional memory and stability, and the perspective gained through experience reduces strategic mistakes. This allows leaders to weigh immediate pressures against long-term consequences, drawing from lessons learned over time rather than impulse or circumstance.

In contemporary corporate environments, authority does not arise solely from hierarchy. It emerges from credibility earned through conduct, insight and integrity. Jambavan't commands respect among the vanaras not because he exercises power, but because his words carry the weight of mature understanding. This reveals another principle of leadership.

Influence grounded in credibility often proves stronger than authority based on position. Those who command respect through knowledge and character are able to guide institutions more effectively than those who rely solely on formal titles.

The most defining episode associated with Jambavan't occurs during the search for Sita. After months of effort, the vanara search party arrives at the southern shore of the ocean. Before them lies the vast sea separating them from Lanka, where Sita is believed to be held captive. The warriors are exhausted and uncertain. Each measures his strength, and even the strongest hesitate, unsure of their ability to cross the ocean. Collective morale begins to weaken. At this moment of uncertainty, Jambavan't intervenes with calm authority. Instead of criticising the hesitation around him, he carefully evaluates the capabilities of each warrior. He acknowledges their strengths while recognising their limitations. This moment reveals another leadership insight. Effective leadership begins with a clear assessment of people and circumstances. Leaders who understand both capability and constraint are able to guide teams toward realistic solutions rather than create unrealistic expectations.

Finally, in the episode, Jambavan't turns to Hanuman, who until that moment has remained silent. He reminds Hanuman of the extraordinary strength and courage he possessed as a child, when he leapt toward the sun, believing it to be a fruit. These powers had been forgotten due to a sage's curse that caused Hanuman to lose awareness of them until reminded. Through thoughtful counsel, Jambavan't awakens Hanuman's dormant confidence and capabilities. The atmosphere instantly transforms, and a sense of optimism arises. What had seemed impossible is now eminently achievable. This provides a principal lesson. One of the most important leadership qualities is recognising talent in others. A leader's role is not only identifying talent but also awakening the potential that lies within individuals.

Equally important is the manner in which Jambavan't accomplishes this task. He does not flatter Hanuman or exaggerate his abilities. Instead, he reminds him of real experiences from his past, such as soaring toward the heavens in feats that astonished even the gods. These abilities had simply remained dormant. This approach reflects another leadership principle. Mentorship must be grounded in authenticity rather than empty praise. Confidence

that emerges from recognition of genuine capability becomes far more resilient than confidence built upon superficial encouragement. In this sense, the episode demonstrates a timeless truth that mentorship creates heroes. Through sincere guidance that restores belief and clarity, leaders enable individuals to rise beyond their own doubts and perform acts that transform the destiny of the entire organisation.

As Hanuman's confidence returns, his hesitation disappears, his form expands, and he declares his resolve to leap across the ocean toward Lanka. The vanara army, which had earlier been overwhelmed by discouragement, now witnesses renewed determination. Despondency gives way to expectation. A single act of wise counsel altered the emotional climate of the entire group. This moment illustrates yet another leadership insight. Leaders provide their people with the psychological heft required to deliver something extraordinary, especially when doubt threatens to cloud judgment and progress.

This episode also reveals another important principle. A leader should always know when to step back. Jambavan't possesses immense experience and authority, yet he does not attempt the leap across the ocean himself. While he was once endowed with great strength and swiftness, he recognises that age has diminished his physical vigour. Instead, he identifies the individual best suited to accomplish the mission and empowers him to act. Identifying potential and using it for the organisational needs is a critical job of a good leader. In this sense, leadership becomes the art of marrying capability with purpose, ensuring that talent serves the broader mission of the institution.

Another striking aspect of Jambavan't's conduct is his restraint. Although he is the eldest and most experienced among the vanaras, he does not dominate discussion or impose authority prematurely. He waits until the moment when his intervention can genuinely alter the course of events. This restraint reveals another leadership principle. Wisdom in leadership often lies in knowing when to speak and when to remain silent. Constant intervention can weaken teams by preventing them from taking initiative or proposing innovative strategies. Thoughtful timing strengthens both resolve and the effectiveness of guidance.

Jambavan't's humility further reinforces his stature. Although he plays a decisive role in awakening Hanuman's potential,

he never seeks recognition for himself. When Hanuman later returns successfully after locating Sita in Lanka, Jambavan't celebrates the achievement as a collective victory. His conduct reflects another enduring lesson. Humility strengthens teams by directing attention toward collective purpose rather than personal acclaim. This also reflects the deeper leadership discipline of purpose over ego. Leaders should always stay purpose-oriented to advance the institution's objectives and goals.

Jambavan't's role during the war in Lanka further reflects his leadership qualities. At a critical moment in the conflict, Indrajit, the formidable son of Ravana, unleashes a divine weapon that leaves many warriors incapacitated on the battlefield. The situation appears dire, and uncertainty spreads across Rama's army. Yet even in this moment of crisis, Jambavan't remains composed. He calmly assesses the situation and directs Hanuman to fetch the life-restoring herb Sanjeevani from the Himalayas to revive the fallen warriors. His clarity of judgment once again comes to the fore. The episode highlights another leadership quality. Stay calm under crises, assess available strengths clearly, and translate insight into timely action.

The Ramayana continues to remain relevant in these contemporary times because it presents leadership not merely as authority but as a moral and social responsibility exercised through character, judgment and restraint. Within its narrative landscape, Jambavan't represents the power of wisdom guided by humility and matured by experience. His influence demonstrates that leadership does not always reveal itself through dramatic action but often appears in the ability to awaken strength and latent talent that sustain the foundational integrity of institutions.

In the final analysis, the story of Jambavan't reminds us that the most enduring leaders are not always those who stand at the forefront of action. Often, they are those who quietly cultivate potential, mentor with sincerity, restore confidence when it fades and guide institutions with patience and wisdom. By recognising potential before it becomes visible and nurturing it with discernment, such leaders create conditions where collective capability flourishes. Through this quiet yet decisive influence, institutions remain resilient, purposeful and aligned with the ideals that give leadership its true meaning.

Views expressed are personal

Echoes of Iraq in Iran

The deepening US-Israeli conflict with Iran resonates with the fragile intelligence claims and strategic overconfidence that once justified the invasion of Iraq and destabilised an entire region

The Middle East has seen its share of wars justified by shaky premises. Still, the escalating US-Israeli confrontation with Iran risks repeating one of the most consequential strategic errors of recent history. The invasion of Iraq in 2003 was launched amid claims of imminent threats and hidden weapons programs that ultimately proved unfounded. Today, many of the arguments being advanced in favour of military action against Iran carry a similar fragility. The consequences, if the conflict deepens, could be equally destabilising.

To understand the stakes, one must first examine the United States' reasoning. Much of the rhetoric surrounding the confrontation rests on claims that collapse under scrutiny. American officials have suggested that Iran posed an imminent threat, yet no credible evidence has surfaced that Tehran was preparing a pre-emptive attack against the United States. Assertions that Iran was on the verge of striking American territory are equally implausible. Iran's ballistic missiles have a range of roughly 1,800 miles, sufficient to threaten regional adversaries but far from capable of reaching North America. Moreover, intelligence estimates have long indicated that Iran remains years away from developing intercontinental ballistic missiles.

Other accusations have been similarly misleading. Claims that thousands of American casualties in Iraq were caused by Iranian-manufactured improvised explosive devices distort the historical record. The overwhelming majority of such weapons were built by Iraqi insurgent groups, many of whom were themselves hostile to Iran. Likewise, the suggestion that Iran had any role in the 2000 attack on the USS Cole is historically inaccurate; that attack was carried out by al-Qaeda, a militant organisation that regards Iran as an ideological adversary.

Human rights criticisms of Iran are more credible. The Iranian government's repression of dissent, particularly during recent waves of protest, has been severe. However, the moral force of these criticisms is weakened by the United States' long-standing alliances with other governments that have carried out comparable or even greater repression. Washington maintains close ties with states such as Saudi Arabia, Egypt, and the United Arab Emirates, whose records on democratic



Deeper the US and Israel become involved in conflict with Iran, more unpredictable the regional and global repercussions will be

freedoms are similarly troubling. Calls for democratic change in Iran, therefore, appear selective and strategic rather than principled.

Indeed, calls for the Iranian public to rise against their government during active military bombardment are unrealistic. History suggests that external attacks tend to strengthen, not weaken, domestic support for embattled governments. During the NATO bombing of Serbia in 1999, the opposition movement against Slobodan Milošević was temporarily weakened as the population rallied in defence of the country. A similar dynamic could unfold in Iran, where nationalist sentiment often runs deeper than ideological divisions.

The debate surrounding Iran's nuclear program further illustrates the contradictions in the case for war. Iranian leaders have repeatedly stated that they do not intend to develop nuclear weapons, a pledge reinforced by religious edicts and diplomatic commitments. More importantly, the 2015 Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action (JCPOA) imposed stringent limits and monitoring mechanisms that made the construction of a nuclear weapon extremely difficult. That agreement collapsed after the United States unilaterally withdrew from it in 2018. Negotiations aimed at reviving the deal had reportedly made progress earlier this year, suggesting that diplomacy had not been exhausted.

If the nuclear issue does not fully explain the push toward confrontation, what does? Part of the answer lies in strategic opportunity. Iran has been weakened

in recent years by internal unrest and by setbacks among its regional partners. The fall of Syria's Assad government in late 2024 removed Tehran's most reliable state ally in the region, while groups such as Hezbollah and the Houthis have suffered significant military losses. Domestically, the Iranian regime faces widespread dissatisfaction following harsh crackdowns on protests.

Weakness does not necessarily translate into imminent collapse. Iran's political system is not centred on a single leader but rather on a network of powerful institutions, including the Revolutionary Guard, the clerical establishment, and various security bodies. Even dramatic events, such as the deaths of senior leaders, are unlikely to dismantle this institutional framework. The state has evolved into a highly militarised authoritarian system with multiple centres of power that share an interest in preserving the existing order. Benjamin Netanyahu has long advocated a more aggressive approach toward Iran, viewing Tehran as Israel's primary strategic threat.

Nevertheless, attributing American policy entirely to Israeli pressure oversimplifies a far longer history. US hostility toward Iran predates the current crisis by decades. In 1953, the United States helped overthrow Iran's democratically elected prime minister, Mohammad Mosaddegh. During the Iran-Iraq War of the 1980s, American forces engaged Iranian naval targets and even shot down a civilian airliner. Washington has repeatedly supported regional rivals of Iran, includ-

ing Gulf monarchies and Saddam Hussein's Iraq.

These policies suggest that the confrontation is rooted less in short-term alliances than in a broader strategic logic. Iran remains one of the few major states in the Middle East capable of challenging American dominance. For decades, US strategic thinking has emphasised maintaining overwhelming military and political superiority, a doctrine sometimes described as "full spectrum dominance." In this context, weakening Iran may be seen as a way to prevent any rival power from emerging in the region.

Such a strategy carries profound risks. Prolonged bombing campaigns rarely achieve regime change on their own. More often, they devastate civilian infrastructure and deepen humanitarian crises. A severely weakened Iran could become politically fragmented, with competing factions, ethnic groups, ideological movements, monarchists, and religious forces struggling for power. Rather than stabilising the region, such fragmentation could create another protracted conflict zone.

In Vietnam, American policymakers framed the conflict as part of a global ideological struggle against communism. Yet the insurgency was driven as much by nationalism as by ideology, and external intervention ultimately strengthened local resistance. Iran may present a similar dynamic. While its government is defined by religious authority, it also draws legitimacy from a deep sense of national independence rooted in centuries of history.

Iran is not a small client state that can be easily reshaped by external pressure. It is an industrialised country of more than ninety million people with a long tradition of statehood stretching back millennia. Attempts to coerce or destabilise such a society through military force alone are unlikely to produce the desired outcome.

Wars launched with confident predictions often end with unexpected consequences. The deeper the United States and Israel become involved in a confrontation with Iran, the more unpredictable the regional and global repercussions will be. Strategic overreach has humbled great powers before. If history is any guide, the attempt to impose order through force may once again produce instability far beyond what its architects intended.

Views expressed are personal

RAJNATH UNVEILS VISION 2047

Govt charts roadmap for modern, agile and multi-domain military

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: An ambitious vision document broadly outlining a series of strategic reforms, capability enhancements and organisational changes required to bolster the Indian military was unveiled by Defence minister Rajnath Singh on Tuesday.

The document, prepared by the Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff (HQ IDS), is a strategic blueprint to transform the Indian armed forces into a modern, multi-domain, and integrated force by the centenary of India's Independence.

The release of the 'Defence Forces Vision 2047: A Roadmap for a Future-Ready Indian Military' came eight months after the military conflict between India and Pakistan. Following the May 7 to 10 conflict, all the three forces were asked to work on the lessons learnt from it.

The vision document envisages the transformation of the military into an integrated, multi-domain and agile force capable of deterring adversaries and to effectively respond to any conflict.

A central pillar of the vision is the emphasis on jointness and synergy among the services, promoting greater coordination in planning, operations and capability development, according to the defence ministry.

It said the blueprint has been articulated by Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff to transform the defence forces into a modern, integrated and technologically-advanced military capable of supporting India's aspiration to become 'Viksit Bharat' (developed India) by 2047.

"The vision document outlines the strategic reforms,



Defence minister Rajnath Singh with Chief of Defence Staff Gen Anil Chauhan and others during a meeting following the release of the book in New Delhi

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The document has been prepared by the Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff (HQ IDS)
- » It is a strategic blueprint to transform the Indian armed forces into a modern, multi-domain, and integrated force by the centenary of India's Independence

capability enhancements and organisational changes required within the defence forces to effectively address the evolving geostrategic, technological and security environment," the ministry said.

"It envisages the transformation of the military into an integrated, multi-domain and agile force capable of deterring adversaries, responding across the full spectrum of conflict and protecting expanding strategic interests, amid the rapidly changing global and regional

dynamics," it said.

The document also highlights the importance of innovation, advanced technologies and modern training framework to build a force that is adaptable to future warfare challenges.

Another key focus area is to promote self-reliance in defence to encourage the development and adoption of indigenous technologies and solutions tailored to the country's unique security requirements.

Strengthening domestic defence manufacturing and technological capabilities is expected to enhance operational readiness while contributing to national growth, the ministry said.

The vision document adopts a calibrated roadmap with clearly prioritised capability goals across short-term, mid-term and long-term timelines, it said.

"This structured approach will guide the development of critical military capabilities, institutional reforms and strategic partnerships required to build a world class defence force," the ministry noted.

'OFFENDING' CONTENT IN CLASS 8 SOCIAL SCIENCE BOOK

Chapter on 'judicial graft': NCERT issues public apology, says textbook withdrawn

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The NCERT issued a public apology on Tuesday for including a chapter on judicial corruption in a recent book that had earned the Supreme Court's ire, and said the entire textbook has been withdrawn.

The social science textbook for Class 8 stated that corruption, a massive backlog of cases and the lack of an adequate number of judges are among the challenges faced by the judicial system.

In a statement issued on Tuesday, the NCERT said: "The National Council of Educational Research and Training has recently published a social science textbook, 'Exploring Society: India and Beyond' Grade 8 (Part 2), which contained Chapter 4 titled 'The Role of Judiciary in our Society'."

INSIGHT

- » 'The director and members of NCERT ... tender an unconditional and unqualified apology for the ... The entire book has been withdrawn and is not available'
- » A three-judge bench comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M



Pancholi had taken suo motu cognisance of the "objectionable" statements about the judiciary in NCERT textbooks

"The director and members of NCERT hereby tender an unconditional and unqualified apology for the said chapter four. The entire book has been withdrawn and is not available," it added.

A three-judge bench comprising Chief Justice of India Surya

Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi had taken suo motu cognisance of the "objectionable" statements about the judiciary in NCERT textbooks after senior advocate Kapil Sibal, alongside Abhishek Singhvi, mentioned the matter

for urgent consideration.

CJI Kant strongly objected to a chapter on judicial corruption in the NCERT's Class 8 curriculum, saying nobody on earth would be allowed to defame the judiciary and taint its integrity.

The Supreme Court imposed a "complete blanket ban" on any further publication, reprinting or digital dissemination of the NCERT's Class 8 social science book as it contains "offending" content on corruption in the judiciary, saying a gunshot has been fired and the institution is bleeding.

The government, on its part, expressed anguish over the inclusion of the controversial section in the book, with Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan promising to fix accountability and take action against those involved in drafting it.

LPG 'shortage' triggers panic buying in UP cities

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: Reports of a shortage of cooking gas cylinders have triggered concern in several cities across Uttar Pradesh, including Lucknow, Prayagraj and Gorakhpur, with many consumers claiming that cylinders are not being delivered even four to five days after booking.

Long queues have begun forming outside gas agencies in some areas. In Gorakhpur, people waiting outside agencies said they had been standing in line for the past two to three days. Some residents compared the situation to conditions two decades ago, when consumers had to wait for months to receive LPG cylinders.

Despite the rush at several agencies, officials have denied any shortage of LPG in the state. Lucknow District Supply Officer

Vijay Pratap Singh said there is no need for consumers to panic. He said the district currently has LPG stock sufficient for about 25 days and supplies are continuing as usual.

Oil marketing companies have also sent messages to customers denying reports of a fuel shortage. The companies said claims of an LPG shortage are misleading and baseless, adding that an adequate stock of fuel is available across the country.

However, industry sources said oil companies have informally restricted the delivery of commercial LPG cylinders. This has affected hotels, restaurants and dhaba operators.

The uncertainty has also created anxiety among consumers, leading to a sudden spike in demand for domestic cylinders in several cities.

People of Bengal ready for change, claims Haryana CM Nayab Saini

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Tuesday said that the people of West Bengal are ready for change and aspire to build a "Viksit Bengal" through transparent governance and development-oriented policies under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Addressing a public gathering during the Parivartan Sankalp Yatra at Kulpi in South 24 Parganas district of West Bengal, Saini said Bengal has a rich cultural and historical legacy and has produced several great personalities who inspired the nation. He said the land of Swami Vivekananda, Syama Prasad Mookerjee, Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose and Bankim Chandra Chatterjee has played



a significant role in shaping India's freedom struggle and cultural identity.

He said the programme was not merely a political event but a call for change to end what he described as corruption, fear and misgovernance in the state. According to him, farmers are not receiving adequate facilities and market support, while unemployment among youth remains a major concern. He also alleged that corruption, appeasement and violence have

become widespread in the state.

Saini claimed that people affected by cyclones and natural disasters were not adequately compensated and alleged that corruption had prevented relief funds from reaching beneficiaries. He further accused the state government of failing to create a conducive environment for industries, leading to job losses and growing public dissatisfaction.

Highlighting welfare schemes, the chief minister said initiatives like the Ayushman Bharat scheme have provided free treatment up to Rs 5 lakh to eligible beneficiaries in Haryana, benefiting around 27 lakh families. He alleged that many poor people in West Bengal were deprived of the scheme's benefits due to administrative and political reasons.

CBI: Central Rly official among 3 held in bribery case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has arrested 3 accused persons, including a senior railway official, in connection with a bribery case linked to alleged irregularities in the award of a major railway tender, officials said on Tuesday.

The CBI filed the case on Monday against Ramesh Kumar Chauve, who is the Chief Electrical Distribution Engineer of Central Railway and an officer of the Indian Railway Service of Electrical Engineers (IRSEE 2003 batch), Anshul Varma and Kanay Varma.

According to the CBI, the dispute arose as there were suspicions of irregularities in the tender of Rs 40.54 crore, which was to be awarded to a private company. Chauve allegedly conspired with the stakeholders of the company and demanded a bribe of Rs 40 lakh, which is approximately 1 percent of the total amount of the tender.

In a sting operation, Chauve was caught taking the bribe of Rs 10 lakh from Anshul Varma, which was recovered from the chamber of the railway official. After the sting operation, Chauve, Anshul Varma, and Kanay Varma were arrested.

During the raids conducted at five locations related to the accused in Mumbai, Navi Mumbai, and Karjat, the CBI recovered cash of Rs 90.79 lakh, gold jewellery worth 241.30 grams, and silver jewellery worth 2,577 grams (approx. worth Rs 42.52 lakh), along with investment-related documents, from the railway official's premises.

In addition to this, an amount of Rs 3.85 lakh was recovered from the railway official's chamber.

The total worth of the recovered items in this case is approximately Rs 1.47 crore, with many other incriminating documents recovered as well.

Punjab Assembly resolution condemns Cong MLA Khaira's remarks on women

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: The Punjab Assembly on Tuesday passed a resolution condemning Congress MLA Sukhpal Singh Khaira over his "derogatory" comments on women celebrating the "Mukh Mantri Mawan Dhiyan Satkar Yojana" under which the state government will provide Rs 1000 per month to eligible beneficiaries.

Four women MLAs of the ruling Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), including Amandeep Kaur Arora, Saravjit Kaur Manu and Inderjit Kaur Mann, protested in the Well of the House demanding an apology from Khaira.

They said the alleged comment was made on social media about women beneficiaries who are receiving Rs 1,000 per month under the state government scheme.

AAP women MLAs protested in the Well of the House, demanding an apology from Khaira

The issue was raised during the Question Hour of the ongoing Budget session by Finance Minister Harpal Singh Cheema.

Leader of Opposition Pratp Singh Bajwa expressed regret over Khaira's post on Facebook. The House was adjourned for half an hour when AAP MLAs protested against the comments.

After the proceedings resumed, Manuke demanded that Khaira should not be allowed to sit in the House until he tenders an apology.

She moved a condemnation motion against Khaira, which

was seconded by the finance minister.

The motion was moved despite the Congress MLAs' urging that Khaira be allowed to give his clarification when he comes to the assembly on Wednesday.

Congress MLA Tript Rajinder Singh Bajwa said Khaira should be allowed to explain regarding his comments before passing any resolution against him.

AAP MLA Inderjit Kaur Mann rejected the suggestion and demanded that the condemnation resolution be passed.

Participating in the discussion on the resolution, Education Minister Harjot Singh Bains said such objectionable comments reflect a feudal mindset. He said that Khaira, who is the Congress legislator from the Bholath seat, stood by his remarks.

MP's Nauradehi Sanctuary to become 3rd cheetah habitat in India: CM Yadav

"The species likely to be released in Nauradehi within next 2 months"

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav on Tuesday announced that the Nauradehi Wildlife Sanctuary will soon become the third home for cheetahs in the country after Kuno National Park and Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary. He said cheetahs are likely to be released in Nauradehi within the next two months.

Yadav made the announcement while addressing ministers ahead of the state Cabinet meeting in Bhopal.

"Cheetahs are flourishing rapidly in Madhya Pradesh. They will be released in the Nauradehi Wildlife Sanctuary in about two months. With this, Madhya Pradesh will have three habitats for cheetahs," the Chief Minister said during the meeting.

The announcement came a day after the Namibian female cheetah Jwala gave birth to five cubs at Kuno National Park, further boosting the big cat population in the state.



Cheetahs in the grasslands of Kuno National Park in Madhya Pradesh, a key site of Project Cheetah

Spread across the districts of Sagar, Damoh and Narsinghpur, the Nauradehi Wildlife Sanctuary is one of the largest wildlife sanctuaries in the state. Its development as a cheetah habitat is expected to ease ecological pressure on Kuno National Park, which currently hosts the largest population of cheetahs under the reintroduction programme.

Following the birth of Jwala's cubs, the cheetah population in

Kuno has risen to 50. Earlier, three cheetahs—one female and two males—were relocated to Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary in Mandasaur district as part of the expansion strategy for the species in the state.

Overall, the cheetah population in Madhya Pradesh now reached 53 under Project Cheetah. The initiative was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on September 17, 2022, with the release

Spread across the districts of Sagar, Damoh and Narsinghpur, the Nauradehi Wildlife Sanctuary is one of the largest wildlife sanctuaries in the state

of eight African cheetahs—five females and three males—from Namibia into Kuno National Park.

The programme marked the world's first intercontinental translocation of a large carnivore and aims to restore the cheetah population in India, which became extinct in 1952.

Subsequently, 12 more cheetahs from South Africa were introduced into Kuno in February 2023. The project, driven by the National Tiger Conservation Authority, seeks to re-establish the ecological role of cheetahs in India's grassland ecosystems while strengthening long-term conservation efforts.

NEW DELHI: A QR code printed on the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) Class 12 mathematics question paper led to the music video of "Never Gonna Give You Up" by British singer Rick Astley.

It became a classic internet prank known as "rickrolling" even as the board maintained that the security of the question paper remains uncompromised.

The mathematics board examination was held on March 9. Soon after the exam got over, images of the question paper began circulating on social media with students alleging that the QR code printed on it redirected them to the 1987 hit song's video on YouTube.

QR codes are typically included on board exam papers for authentication and security verification.

"Many security features are

TAKEAWAYS

- » QR codes are typically included on board exam papers for authentication and security verification
- » In a few question paper sets, it appears that when one of the given QR codes is scanned, it links to a YouTube video

provided on question papers. These include QR codes to verify the genuineness of the question paper in case of a suspected security breach. On March 9, an examination in Mathematics was conducted for class 12. In a few question paper sets, it appears that when one of the given QR codes is scanned, it links to a YouTube video," CBSE Examination Controller Sanyam

- » The board noted that while the concerns about the veracity of the question papers have been put to rest, the matter has been viewed seriously
- » CBSE said necessary steps are being taken by the board to ensure such issues are not repeated in future

Bhardwaj said. "It appears that this has raised concerns about the veracity of the question papers amongst concerned students and parents. It is confirmed that question papers are genuine and the security of the question paper remains uncompromised," he added.

The board noted that while the concerns about the verac-

Assam, N-E witness rapid expansion in rail connectivity



MALIGAON: Rail connectivity in Assam and the Northeast is witnessing rapid expansion with higher investments and new infrastructure projects.

The average annual railway budget allocation for the region has risen from about Rs 2,122 crore during 2009-14 to Rs 11,486 crore in 2026-27, nearly a fivefold increase.

Currently, projects worth over Rs 72,468 crore are underway, including new railway lines, station modernisation and safety initiatives. Sixty stations are being redeveloped under the Amrit Bharat Station Scheme in the region.

Since 2014, nearly 1,900 km of new railway lines have been built, while electrification has advanced significantly. The Prime Minister is also set to launch key projects, including the Furkating-Tinsukia doubling line and a POH workshop at Bashbari.

'Nearly 1 mn die every year in India due to tobacco-related diseases'

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: On the occasion of "No Smoking Day" on March 11, Director of Mental Health, Haryana, and senior psychiatrist Dr Brahmdeep appealed to people to stay away from tobacco and smoking.

He said that smoking and tobacco consumption are among the leading causes of preventable deaths and diseases worldwide. According to the WHO, tobacco causes about 8 million deaths globally every year, while in India alone, more than 1 million people die annually due to tobacco-related illnesses.

He further stated that around 27 percent of cancers in India are directly linked to tobacco consumption, including lung cancer, oral and throat cancer, as well as serious health conditions such as heart disease, stroke, Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD), increased severity of asthma, and complications during pregnancy.

Dr Brahmdeep explained that smokers have about a 2-4 times higher risk of heart disease and a 20-25 times higher

risk of lung cancer.

He added that tobacco smoke not only harms the person who smokes but also severely affects the health of people around them—especially children and women. He emphasised that positive changes in the body begin very quickly after quitting smoking.

He said that under the guidance of Haryana Chief Minister, Nayab Singh Saini, Tobacco Cessation Centres have been established in all civil hospitals and medical colleges across the state, where trained doctors and paramedical staff provide counselling, treatment, and necessary guidance.

Dr Brahmdeep advised people who wish to quit smoking to set a specific quit date and make a firm commitment, avoid keeping cigarettes or tobacco products nearby, take deep breaths or drink water when cravings arise, engage in other activities, seek support from family and friends, and consult a doctor or tobacco cessation center if needed. He also recommended regular exercise, yoga, and maintaining a healthy daily routine.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

No:- 128/WSr.DEN-C/NIT-15-25-26-WC

Dated: 10.03.2026

The Sr. DEN/C, Northern Railway, Delhi Division for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender on prescribed form for the following work.

Invitation of tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

1	Name of work with its location	TSR(P)-130 TKM / TRR(P)-19.70 TKM with TRT machine over Delhi Division.
2	Approx cost of work	Rs. 18,17,98,117.57/-
3	Earnest money	Rs. 10,59,000/-
4	Date and Starting time for filling e-tender & Tender opening time	Starting time for filling e-tender is Date- 17.03.2026 at 15:00 hrs. & Tender opening time is Date- 02.04.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
5	Website particulars, published e-tender, notice location etc. complete details of tender can be seen and web site where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

801/26

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

The Divisional Engineer/Track, Northern Railway, Delhi Division for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender on prescribed form for the following work

1.	Name of work with its location	Reconditioning of tamping tools for track machines in DLI Division under DEN/Track. (Cost is inclusive of GST).
2.	Approx. Cost of work	(1) Rs. 85,31,650/-
3.	Earnest Money	(1) Rs. 1,71,000/-
4.	Date and Starting time for filling e-tender & tender opening time	Starting time for filling e-tender is Date- 17/03/2026 at 15:00 hrs. & Tender opening time is Date- 02/04/2026 at 15:00 hrs.
5.	Website particulars, published e-tender, notice location etc. complete details of tender can be seen and web site where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

No: 128/WSr.DEN-C/NIT-16-25-26-WC Dated: 10.03.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

802/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.U/s 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Salman S/o Umed Ali R/o H. No. 1199, Gali No. 9, C-Block, Sangam Vihar, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **e-FIR No. 91/2024 U/s 392/411/414/34 IPC PS: Jagatpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Salman** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Salman** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Salman** accused of **e-FIR No. 91/2024 U/s 392/411/414/34 IPC PS: Jagatpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.04.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Anushtha Srivastava
Ld. JMFC-05, Room No. 07,
Second Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/3003/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice

Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001 for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	07250180	Over Hauling Kit for Leveling Valve	1901 Set	27.03.2026
02	19251697B	Panto Foot Insulator As per CLW	324 Nos	30.03.2026
03	77269035	10 MM Thick Nylon Cord Pocket Type RGC	944 Set	01.04.2026
04	08265161	Supply installation wiring testing of SSDAC	22 Nos	06.04.2026
05	08265145	Electric Point Operating Machine IRS	185 Nos	06.04.2026
06	77269042	10 MM Thick Pocket Type Nylon Cord RGC	307 Set	13.04.2026

Note: 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice No. 92/2025-2026 Dated: 09.03.2026 795/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited

Regd Office: Plot No 10, Paigah Colony, Sector Patel Road, Secundrabad-500003, Telangana India

CIN:U40107G1997PLC028483

(A wholly owned subsidiary of Gurgaon Amara Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)

(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD- MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, Distt: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specification"

1 Tender Enquiry No 132/GATP/MMD/SPARES/20018019 dated 10/03/2026

"Procurement of 100 NB and 80 NB ERW Pipes at 2x270 MW Gurgaon Amardas Thermal Plant (GATPL), Goindwal Sahib, Distt: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specification"

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to eproc.punjab.gov.in on 10/03/2026 from 17:00 Hrs onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

GATP-25/26

PR-Adv. No :- 1079/12/2025-26/9256

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
(SUCCESSION CASE)
IN THE COURT OF Sh.Rajeev
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division) Hissar

1. Jiya, Daughter of Late Vinod Kumar Minor
2. Master Ansh Kumar s/o Late Vinod Kumar
3. Master Gurvish Kumar s/o Late Vinod Kumar
(all minors through their grandmother & natural guardian Bharto Devi)
4. Bharto Devi w/o Vijay Singh Ali R/o Village Landhi Sukhlambarn District Hissar
Vs.
1. Neetu w/o Late Vinod Kumar R/o Kutub Hissar
Petition U/s 372 of the Indian Succession Act, 1925 for grant of succession certificate
CNR No. HRH502-002925-2025
Next Date:-21-04-2026
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 21-04-2026 at 10:00 am.
For details login to <https://highcourthd.gov.in/2mod> = district notice & district = Hissar
Sd/- Sh. Rajeev
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division) dated 09.03.2026 Hissar

millenniumpost
CLASSIFIEDS

LOST OF FOUND

I, Rameet Kaur Kohli W/o
Puneet Singh Kohli, R/o, A-104, Ground Floor, Vivek Vihar Phase-I, Delhi-110095, do hereby inform that document No.386,dated 18.01.1972, RD No. 10454, Dated 27.11.2001, RD Nos. 29312 & 13, dated 11.11.2010 and sale deed No. 19979, dated 09.10.2013, have been lost in original alongwith other relevant documents in respect of property No. B-188, Upper Ground Floor, Janta Colony, Shivaji Vihar, Delhi-110027, relates to my mother Smt. Surinder Kaur. If anybody found please contact above address (9650618182).

CHANGE OF NAME
I, Anjum D/o, Istya Khan R/o H. No. B-61, Shalimar Garden Main, Sahibabad, PO: Sahibabad, Distt. Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201005. That in 10th School Certificate S.No. SSE/2008/697738 my father's name has been written as Istya Khan and in Passport No. L7397829 My father's name has been written as Mohd Shafiq. That my father's name Istya Khan & Mohd Shafiq are both the name of the same and one person. That in future my father's name should be known as ISTYA KHAN.

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
(UNDER GUARDIAN AND WARD ACT)
IN THE COURT OF Sh.Rajeev
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division) Hissar
Kanta Devi widow of Rajbir Singh s/o Navrang R/o 347 A amar Vihar Colony Gangwa Teh & Distt Hissar.
Vs.
General Public
Petition U/s 8 of the Hindu Minority and Guardianship Act,1956 for seeking permission to sell the agricultural land of Parul (minor daughter of petitioner) 39/770 shares, land of Aditya (minor son of petitioner) 39/770 share out of total land measuring 30 Kanal 16 Marla comprised in Khewat No. 1954 Khatoni No. 3021 jamaabandi for the years 2020-2021 situated at Vill. Siswal, Teh. Adampur, Distt. Hissar.
CNR No. HRH502-001341-2025
Next Date:-18-04-2026
NOTICE TO:
General Public and relatives
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 18-04-2026 at 10:00 am.
For details login to <https://highcourthd.gov.in/2mod> = district notice & district = Hissar
Sd/- Sh. Rajeev
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division) dated 09.03.2026 Hissar

ICICI Bank

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Ltd., BP-4, Technopolis Building, 4th Floor, Sector V, Salt Lake City, Kolkata West Bengal- 700091
CIN No: L65190G1994PLC021012. www.icicibank.com

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Garima Gargee/ Yohan Singh/ W/o Yohan Singh, 09102, Aits Advantage, Ahinsa Khand-I, Near Aditya Mall, Indrapuram, Shripani Suncity Uttar Pradesh Ghaziabad- 201014/ TBCAL00006756134/ LBCAL00006789337/ TBCAL00006767967/ TBCAL00006785831	"Dharitri Titanium", Flat No.A2(3), 4th Floor, Block No.1st, Holding No. 17, Methopara Road, C.S. Dag No. 1266, Khatian No. 903, R.S./L.R. Dag No. 1268, Khatian No. 904, R.S./L.R. Dag No. 1262, 1263, 1265, R.S./L.R. Khatian No. 25, J.L. No. 45, Re. Sa. No. 132 And 139, Touzi No. 146, Mouza Doharia, Village Methopara, P.S. Barasat, Madhyamgram Municipality, A.D.S.R.O. Barasat, District North 24 Parganas, West Bengal. (Admeasuring An Area of 397 Sq. Ft. Super Built Up Area More or Less Along With All That The Proportionate Undivided Inseible Share In The Land Comprised In The Plinth of The Flat Including Garage And Amenities. North:20 Feet Wide Municipal Road South: R.S. Dag No. 1261 East: Part of R.S. Dag No. 1264, 1265, 1266 And 1267. West: Part of R.S. Dag No. 1269, 1270, 1271 And 1262/ Date of Symbolic 05/03/2026	October 21, 2025 Rs. 58,61,764.85/-	Ghazia- bad/ Kolkata/ Gurgaon/ Indrapuram,
2.	Garima Gargee/ Yohan Singh/ W/o Yohan Singh, 09102, Aits Advantage, Ahinsa Khand-I, Near Aditya Mall, Indrapuram, Shripani Suncity Uttar Pradesh Ghaziabad- 201014 TBCAL00006756110	"Dharitri Titanium", Flat No.A1(3), 4th Floor, Block No. 1st, Holding No. 17, Methopara Road, C.S. Dag No. 1266, Khatian No. 903, R.S./L.R. Dag No. 1268, Khatian No. 904, R.S./L.R. Dag No. 1262, 1263, 1265, R.S./L.R. Khatian No. 25, J.L. No. 45, Re. Sa. No. 132 And 139, Touzi No. 146, Mouza Doharia, Village Methopara, P.S. Barasat, Madhyamgram Municipality, A.D.S.R.O. Barasat, District North 24 Parganas, West Bengal. (Admeasuring An Area of 914 Sq. Ft. Super Built Up Area More or Less Along With All That The Proportionate Undivided Inseible Share In The Land Comprised In The Plinth of The Flat Including Garage And Amenities. North:20 Feet Wide Municipal Road South: R.S. Dag No. 1261 East: Part of R.S. Dag No. 1264, 1265, 1266 And 1267. West: Part of R.S. Dag No. 1269, 1270, 1271 And 1262/ Date of Symbolic 05/03/2026	October 21, 2025 Rs. 32,55,353.00/-	Ghazia- bad/ Kolkata/ Gurgaon/ Indrapuram,
3.	Sukhwendar Singh/ Golf City Plot -11, Sec-75, 1204 Tower H2, Gautam Buddha Nagar District Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar Pradesh Noida- 201303/ TBCAL00006621258/ LBCAL00006634508	Dharitri Titanium", Flat No. D, 1st Floor, Block No. 1, Holding No. 17, Methopara Road, C.S. Dag No. 1266, Khatian No. 903, R.S./L.R. Dag No. 1268, Khatian No. 904, R.S./L.R. Dag No. 1262, 1263 & 1265, R.S./L.R. Khatian No. 25, Re. Sa. No. 132 & 139, Touzi No. 146, JI No. 45, Mouza Doharia, Village Methopara, P.S. Barasat, Madhyamgram Municipality, A.D.S.R.O. Barasat, District North 24 Parganas, West Bengal. (Admeasuring An Area of 1211 Sq. Ft. Super Built Up Area More or Less Along With One Car Parking Space At Ground Floor, Block 1, Area About 135 Sq. Ft. Super Built Up Area (Position Will Be Allotted As Per Developer Choice) Including All Easements Right To The Said Land. North:20 Feet Wide Municipal Road South: R. S. Dag No. 1261 East: Part of R.S. Dag Nos. 1264, 1265, 1266 & 1267 West: Part of R.S. Dag Nos. 1269, 1270, 1271 & 1262/ Date of Symbolic 05/03/2026	October 24, 2025 Rs. 40,12,508.90/-	Noida/ Kolkata
4.	Sukhwendar Singh/ Golf City Plot -11, Sec-75, 1204 Tower H2, Gautam Buddha Nagar District Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar Pradesh Noida- 201303/ LBCAL00006634517/ TBCAL00006621348	Dharitri Titanium", Flat No. E2, 3rd Floor, Block No. 1, Holding No. 17, Methopara Road, C.S. Dag No. 1266, Khatian No. 903, R.S./L.R. Dag No. 1268, Khatian No. 904, R.S./L.R. Dag No. 1262, 1263 & 1265, R.S./L.R. Khatian No. 25, Re. Sa. No. 132 & 139, Touzi No. 146, JI No. 45, Mouza Doharia, Village Methopara, P.S. Barasat, Madhyamgram Municipality, A.D.S.R.O. Barasat, District North 24 Parganas, West Bengal. (Admeasuring An Area of 1061 Sq. Ft. Super Built Up Area More or Less Along With One Car Parking Space At Ground Floor, Block 1, Area About 135 Sq. Ft. Super Built Up Area (Position Will Be Allotted As Per Developer Choice) Including All Easements Right To The Said Land. North:20 Feet Wide Municipal Road South: R. S. Dag No. 1261 East: Part of R.S. Dag Nos. 1264, 1265, 1266 & 1267 West: Part of R.S. Dag Nos. 1269, 1270, 1271 & 1262/ Date of Symbolic 05/03/2026	October 24,2025 Rs. 35,86,204.19/-	Noida/ Kolkata
5.	Sumit Roy Chowdhury/ Kalpana Roy Chowdhury/ 33/BB Ranipark Kamahati Belgharia, P.O. And P.S. Belgharia, District North 24 Pgs West Bengal Kolkata - 700056/ LBCAL00005670847	"Grand One", of "Shriram Grand City", Residential Apartment No. D12-06-04, 6th Floor, Tower-12, Cluster D, L.R. Dag No. 4474(P), R.S. Dag Nos. 568, 335, 334, 330, 329, 307, 354, 435, 431, 422, 436, 434, 432,424, 425, 426, 427, 460, 461, 462, 463, 457, 456, 448, 449, 447, 500, 501-504, 506-509, 398, 612, 641, 642, 649, 650, 652, 654, 656, 606, 609, 658, 430, 644, 676, L.R. Khatian No. 11976, R.S. Khatian No. 11721, Mouza Konnagar, J.L. No. 7, Police Station Uttarpara, Kanaipuri Gram Panchayat, District Hooghly, West Bengal, Owned By Sumit Roy Chowdhury (Admeasuring An Area of Super Built Up Area Approx 469.5 Sq. Ft., Built Up Area Approx 375.6 Sq. Ft., Carpet Area 315.2 Sq. Ft. Exclusive Balcony Approx 22.6 Sq. Ft. Along With The Proportionate Undivided Inseible Importable Share And Right To Use Common Areas And Common Utilities North: Partly By L.R. Dag No. 4474(P) Within Mouza Konnagar And Partly By L.R. Dag No. 1904 Within Mouza Khodrabahera South: By L.R. Dag No. 4474(P) East: By L.R. Dag No. 4474(P) West: Partly By L.R. Dag No. 4474(P) Partly By L.R. Dag No. 4475 And Partly By L.R. Dag No. 4476, All Within Mouza Konnagar/ Date of Symbolic 05/03/2026	October 28, 2025 Rs. 14,87,892.00/-	Hooghly/ Gurgaon

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: March 11, 2026
Place: Delhi/Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No. JHS-N-W-29-26

Date:- 07.03.2026

E-Tendering Notice

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/ Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following works.

Tender No.:- JHS-N-W-29-26, Name of work: Comprehensive annual maintenance of Kyoson make Electronic Interlocking at 15 Stations as JHS El-II, KRQ, DAA, PA CHIT HP SOR, KTRA CHIT, HPP, RNRD, RORA, MRPR, RGU, BSZ, JSB, TKA, NLT and 11 LSC/RH as LSC28, RH-4, LSC27, LSC26, LSC24, LSC23, LSC22, LSC21, LSC20, LSC19, LSC18 of Jhansi division for a period of three years.

Approx Cost : ₹ 17,35,10,666.28 Earnest Money: ₹ 10,17,600/-

Cost of Tender Form: ₹ Nil Opening of tender : 30.03.2026, Time 15:00

Completion period from issue of tender of acceptance: 36 Months.

(1) Tender on line can be submitted upto 15.00 hrs on 30.03.2026. (2) For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. (NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-SAND T) 534/26 (MG)

www.northcentralrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC/84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **MD. Jafar @ Rahul S/o Shami, R/o 3 1/2 Pusta, Gali No. 14, Shastri Park, Delhi and T-218, 3rd Floor, Gali No. 2, Zero Pusta, Shastri Park, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 623/2022 U/S 474/34 IPC, PS Subzi Mandi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **MD. Jafar @ Rahul** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **MD. Jafar @ Rahul** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **MD. Jafar @ Rahul of FIR No. 623/2022 U/S 474/34 IPC, PS Subzi Mandi, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **17.04.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Preeti Rajoria
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
Room No. 32, (Central)
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/3085/N/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Manoj S/o Shiv Prasad R/o D-1/252, Nand Nagri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 482/2022 U/S 452/323/506/34 IPC, PS Nand Nagri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Manoj** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Manoj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Manoj of FIR No. 482/2022 U/S 452/323/506/34 IPC, PS Nand Nagri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **22.04.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class- 03
Room No. 19, First Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/3069/NE/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Sheer Singh@Jaadu S/o Sh. Rampal R/o Jhuggi E-Block JJ Colony Bawana Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 236/2019 U/s 392/397/411 IPC PS: Begumpur Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sheer Singh @Jaadu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sheer Singh@Jaadu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sheer Singh@Jaadu** accused of **FIR No. 236/2019 U/s 392/397/411 IPC PS: Begumpur Rohini, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.04.2026**.

By Order

Sh. Sachin Mittal
ASJ-05 (North-West) Room No. 217
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/2996/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82 Cr.P.C.)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Bappu Ghose @ Sonu Ghose S/o Mangal Ghose R/o Flat No. 302, 3rd Floor, Plot No. 3045 Vinayak Apartment Calcutta, West Bengal and J-421, Ambedkar Nagar, Sector-5, Dakshinipuri, Near Kali Mandir, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CR No. 5302/2024, FIR No. 20610/2023, U/s 379/411 IPC Act, PS Krishna Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Bappu Ghose @ Sonu Ghose** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Bappu Ghose @ Sonu Ghose** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Bappu Ghose @ Sonu Ghose** of case **CR No. 5302/2024, FIR No. 20610/2023, U/s 379/411 IPC Act, PS Krishna Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **03.08.2026**.

By Order

Sh. P. Bhargav Rao
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Room No. 3, 2nd Floor, East Dist.
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/2579/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **SONU S/o Rajender Prasad, R/o: B-135A, Lal Pul Prahladpur, New Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 279/2023, U/S 279/304A IPC, PS Okhla Industrial Area, South-East Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **SONU** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **SONU** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **SONU** the said accused of **FIR No. 279/2023, U/S 279/304A IPC, PS Okhla Industrial Area, South-East Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.04.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Akansha Gautam
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02,
South-East Distt., Room No.-513,
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/2576/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Amit Kumar S/o Lt. Dalel Singh, R/o H.No. B-08, Vishnu Park, Uttam Nagar, Delhi, Also at: H.No. B-08, Vishvas Park, Uttam Nagar, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 121/25, U/S 331(3)/305/317(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS Nihal Vihar, Outer Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Amit Kumar** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Amit Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Amit Kumar** the said accused of **FIR No. 121/25, U/S 331(3)/ 305/317(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS Nihal Vihar, Outer Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.04.2026**.

By Order

Ms. Komal Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
West Distt., Room No. 292,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/3049/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

GOVERNMENT OF WEST BENGAL
NEW TOWN KOLKATA DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
NOTICE INVITING ONLINE ITEM RATE e-QUOTATION NO. WNKDA/24/ E-P&G (NKDA OF 2025-26 (2nd C&B))
Online e-Tender has been invited for the following works: Licensing of premium office space located at BG-12, Action Area-1B, adjacent to International Bus Stand at New Town, Kolkata.

Estimated Amount: To be quoted by the bidders. Last date & time of submission of technical and financial bid (On-line): 20/04/2026 upto 2.00 P.M. Details available on Website: <https://wbenders.gov.in> & www.nkdamar.org and the office notice board of NKDA
Administrative Officer (EM)
New Town Kolkata Development Authority

GOVERNMENT OF WEST BENGAL
NEW TOWN KOLKATA DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
NOTICE INVITING ONLINE ITEM RATE e-QUOTATION NO. WNKDA/27/E-P&G (NKDA OF 2025-26 (2nd C&B))
e-Tender has been invited for the following works:
1. Maintaining Arboriculture of 03 Nos. Green Verges named (G.V. No.1 & 3) situated at Action Area-II-B and (G.V. No.4) situated at Action Area-II-C within New Town, Kolkata under NKDA (For 01 year).
2. Maintaining Arboriculture of 03 Nos. Green Verges named (G.V. No.6) situated at Action Area-II-C and (G.V. No.7 & 8) situated at Action Area-II-C within New Town, Kolkata under NKDA (For 01 year).
Estimated Amount: To be quoted by the bidders. Last date & time of submission of technical and financial bid (On-line): 18/03/2026 upto 1.00 P.M. Details available on Website: <https://wbenders.gov.in> & www.nkdamar.org and the office notice board of NKDA
Executive Engineer (P&GV)
New Town Kolkata Development Authority

GOVERNMENT OF WEST BENGAL
NEW TOWN KOLKATA DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
NOTICE INVITING ONLINE ITEM RATE e-QUOTATION NO. WNKDA/24/ E-P&G (NKDA OF 2025-26 (2nd C&B))
e-Tender has been invited for the following works:
1. Maintaining Arboriculture of 03 Nos. Green Verges named (G.V. No.21) situated at Action Area-II-C and (G.V. No. 22 & 23) situated at Action Area-II-C within New Town, Kolkata under NKDA (For 01 year).
2. Maintaining Arboriculture of 03 Nos. Green Verges named (G.V. No. 9, 9 & 10) situated at Action Area-II-B within New Town, Kolkata under NKDA (For 01 year)
3. Maintaining Arboriculture of 06 Nos. Green Verges named (G.V. No. 11, 12 & 14 situated at Action Area-II-B & (G.V. No. 13, 15 & 16) situated at Action Area-II-C within New Town, Kolkata under NKDA (For 01 year).
Estimated Amount: To be quoted by the bidders. Last date & time of submission of technical and financial bid (On-line): 25/03/2026 upto 2.00 P.M. Details available on Website: <https://wbenders.gov.in> & www.nkdamar.org and the office notice board of NKDA
Executive Engineer (P&GV)
New Town Kolkata Development Authority

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely: **Sanjay @ Atma, S/o. Ram Bahal, R/o. H.No.9697, Gali No. 9, Mulatani Dhandra, Paharganj, Delhi Mob. No. 9718989979** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.5416/2021 U/S 379/41**

Markets rebound as Sensex rises 640 pts as oil prices fall

Global oil benchmark Brent fell 9.03% to \$90.26/barrel

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Stock market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended nearly 1 per cent higher on Tuesday after two days of massive decline, following a drop in crude oil prices and recovery in global peers amid indications that the West Asia crisis could end soon.

The 30-share BSE Sensex jumped 639.82 points or 0.82 per cent to settle at 78,205.98. During the day, it surged 960.09 points or 1.23 per cent to 78,526.25.

The 50-share NSE Nifty climbed 233.55 points or 0.97 per cent to end at 24,261.60.

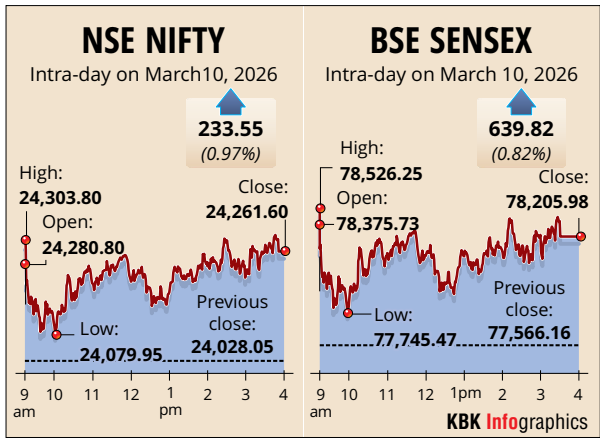
Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, tumbled 9.03 per cent to \$90.26 per barrel.

From the 30-Sensex firms, Mahindra & Mahindra, Inter-Globe Aviation, Maruti, ICICI Bank, Asian Paints and Ultra-Tech Cement were among the major gainers.

Eternal, Infosys, Reliance Industries and Bharti Airtel were among the laggards.

The BSE smallcap select index jumped 1.91 per cent, and the midcap select index climbed 1.71 per cent.

Among BSE sectoral indices, auto surged 2.93 per cent, consumer durables rose 2.60 per cent, services 2.35 per cent, BSE PSU Bank 2.29 per cent,



Among BSE sectoral indices, auto surged 2.93%, consumer durables rose 2.60%, services 2.35%, BSE PSU Bank 2.29%, consumer discretionary 2.07%, financial services 2.01%, commodities 1.74%, and Private Banks index 1.72%

consumer discretionary 2.07 per cent, financial services 2.01 per cent, commodities 1.74 per cent, and Private Banks index 1.72 per cent. IT, energy, oil & gas and BSE Focused IT were the laggards.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 6,345.57 crore on Monday, according to exchange data. Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs), how-

ever, bought stocks worth Rs 9,013.80 crore.

“Indian equity markets witnessed a strong rebound today as easing geopolitical concerns and a sharp reversal in crude oil prices helped restore investor confidence after recent volatility.

“The Nifty-50 advanced over 200 points, supported by improving global sentiment as markets reacted positively to

Highlights

» From the 30-Sensex firms, Mahindra & Mahindra, InterGlobe Aviation, Maruti, ICICI Bank, Asian Paints & UltraTech Cement were among major gainers

» Eternal, Infosys, Reliance Industries & Bharti Airtel were among laggards

» The BSE smallcap select index jumped 1.91%, and the midcap select index climbed 1.71%

» FIIs offloaded equities worth Rs 6,345.57 crore on Monday. Domestic Institutional Investors (DII), however, bought stocks worth Rs 9,013.80 crore

signs that tensions surrounding the ongoing Middle East conflict may begin to ease,” Hariprasad K, Research Analyst and Founder, Livelong Wealth, said.

On Monday, the Sensex tanked 1,352.74 points or 1.71 per cent to settle at 77,566.16, registering its second day of decline. On similar lines, the Nifty dropped 422.40 points or 1.73 per cent to end at 24,028.05.

Equity mutual funds investments rise 8% to ₹25,978 crore in February

The inflow lifted industry's Assets Under Management (AUM) to Rs 82 lakh crore in February from Rs 81 lakh crore in January, according to Amfi data

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Equity mutual funds attracted net inflows of Rs 25,978 crore in February, marking an 8 per cent rise from the previous month, suggesting that investor participation remained resilient despite intermittent market volatility and global uncertainties.

The increase came following two consecutive months of moderation in equity inflows, the inflow lifted the industry's Assets Under Management (AUM) to Rs 82 lakh crore in February from Rs 81 lakh crore in January, according to data released by industry body Amfi on Tuesday.

In a conference call, Venkat N Chalasani, CEO of Amfi said that positive inflow in equities could be driven by the India-US trade deal.

“There could be some volatility this month due to the escalating Middle East conflict involving the US, Israel, and Iran but India's growth story will continue in the long-term,” he added.

However, SIP (Systematic Investment Plans) inflows dipped slightly to around Rs 29,845 crore in February from Rs 31,000 crore in the preceding month.

According to Chalasani, February's SIP collections were impacted by the shorter month



However, SIP inflows dipped slightly to around Rs 29,845 crore in February from Rs 31,000 crore in the preceding month

because installments scheduled for the 29th, 30th and 31st typically process in early March, slightly deferring a portion of contributions to the following month.

Going by the data, equity inflows rose to Rs 25,978 crore in February, higher than the Rs 24,028 crore seen in the preceding month. Equity inflows were at Rs 28,054 crore in December and Rs 29,911 crore in November.

“February 2026 was another volatile month for markets, yet the Indian mutual fund industry demonstrated remarkable resilience. This is a clear signal that investors are increasingly

looking at long-term and past short-term volatility,” Varun Gupta, CEO, Groww Mutual Fund said.

Within equity schemes, flexi cap funds attracted the highest net inflow of Rs 6,924.65 crore. Also, there has been a sharp pickup in flows into the mid-cap and small-cap categories.

Mid-cap funds attracted net inflows of about Rs 4,003 crore, higher than Rs 3,185 crore in January, while small-cap funds garnered around Rs 3,881 crore, up from Rs 2,942 crore in the previous month.

“This indicates that investors continued to selectively allocate towards higher-growth segments despite valuation concerns, possibly taking advantage of recent market corrections,” said Himanshu Srivastava, Principal Research, Morningstar Investment Research India.

Sectoral and thematic funds also saw inflows of Rs 2,987 crore, while large-cap funds saw net additions of Rs 2,112 crore.

However, ELSS funds recorded a net outflow of Rs 650 crore, suggesting some profit booking or reduced tax-saving investments during the period.

Overall, the industry recorded net inflows of Rs 94,530 crore during the month,

lower than the Rs 1.56 lakh crore registered in January.

Inflows into Gold exchange-traded funds (ETFs) moderated to Rs 5,255 crore in February, from a record infusion of Rs 24,040 crore in January and Rs 11,647 crore in December.

“The recent volatility and strong returns in gold and silver attracted significant investor interest, and the current outflows from precious metal ETFs appear to be a phase of profit booking after a strong rally,” said Santosh Joseph, CEO of Germinate Investor Services.

Debt-oriented mutual fund categories continued to see healthy net inflows in February, though at a slower pace than the previous month, garnering Rs 42,106 crore compared with Rs 74,827 crore in January.

“The moderation suggests that while liquidity flows remained supportive, the strong treasury redeployment observed in January post year-end had started to taper off,” Nehal Meshram, Senior Analyst - Manager Research, Morningstar Investment Research India, said.

Inflows were primarily concentrated at the shorter end of the yield curve, with liquid funds emerging as the top-performing category, attracting Rs 59,077 crore.

Rupee rises 36 paise to 91.85 against dollar



MUMBAI: The rupee staged a strong recovery from its record low against the US dollar on Tuesday, gaining 36 paise to settle at 91.85, aided by a sharp fall in global crude oil prices over hopes of de-escalation of the ongoing conflict in West Asia.

Sharp gains in the domestic equity markets, along with a weaker greenback, provided further support to the domestic unit, according to forex traders.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 91.92 against the US dollar and traded in the range of 91.71-92.19.

The local currency finally settled at 91.85 against the US dollar, up 36 paise from its previous close.

The rupee crashed to its all-time closing low of 92.21 against the US dollar on Monday, down 39 paise, as global crude oil prices saw a sharp spike, and the greenback strengthened.

The dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading 0.52 per cent lower at 98.65.

Foreign institutional investors sold equities worth Rs 6,345.57 crore on a net basis on Monday, according to exchange data.

Govt looking to help exporters on insurance front amid West Asia crisis

NEW DELHI: Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Tuesday said the government is looking to extend help to exporters on the insurance front to help them deal with the ongoing West Asia crisis.

He said an inter-ministerial group is keeping tabs on developments on a daily basis and is interacting with exporters. The Customs department has come out with norms for dealing with export cargo returning to Indian ports due to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz and disruptions in maritime routes amid the West Asia crisis.

“Similarly, we are looking for developing some new schemes like insurance support... We are consulting ECGC (Export Credit Guarantee Corporation) and other departments on that,” Goyal told reporters here.

He said the government is



Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal

looking at ways to help exporters whose goods have been shipped but are facing problems. The government is monitoring the situation 24 hours, he added.

Exporters are facing issues due to a joint attack launched by the US and Israel on Iran. It has led to a spike in ocean freight, air transport, and insurance premiums because of dis-

ruptions in the movement of oil and gas consignments. West Asia is a major export destination for India.

Meanwhile, speaking at Aahar show, he said India should aspire to become a top exporter of agri and processed food sectors. At present, India is the seventh-largest exporter of the world.

Agriculture and fish exports stood around Rs 5 lakh crore.

Goyal also said the nine free trade agreements (FTAs) finalised by India have opened huge export opportunities for Indian goods. “We are now finalising an agreement with Canada. We have just launched discussions with the six nations, GCC group of countries, in the Middle East. All of this provides huge opportunities for friends from the processed food and agri sector,” the minister said.

Govt seeks Parl's nod to spend net additional ₹2.01 lakh crore in FY26

NEW DELHI: The government on Tuesday sought Parliament's approval to spend net additional Rs 2.01 lakh crore in the current financial year ending March 31, with a hefty chunk of the expenditure going towards food and fertiliser subsidy.

As per the second batch of Supplementary Demands for Grants tabled in the Lok Sabha by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, the government has sought permission for gross additional spending of Rs 2.81 lakh crore.

Out of this, Rs 80,146 crore will be met from enhanced receipts or recoveries of the ministries and departments, and the net cash expenditure would be over Rs 2.01 lakh crore.

In December 2025, the government had brought the first supplementary demands for



grants seeking Parliament nod for gross extra spending of Rs 1.32 lakh crore, and net additional spending of Rs 41,455 crore.

The government sought Rs 19,230 crore for the fertilisers department and Rs 23,641 crore for subsidies under Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana (PMGKAY).

Other major expenditure heads include Rs 41,822 crore for the defence ministry.

In the Revised Estimates for current fiscal, the govern-

ment has cut total expenditure to Rs 49.65 lakh crore, from Rs 50.65 lakh crore. Till January, the government had spent Rs 36.90 lakh crore, according to Controller General of Accounts (CGA) data.

ICRA Chief Economist Aditi Nayar said although the net cash outgo under the second supplementary demand for grants has been pegged at a sizeable Rs 2 lakh crore, this is likely to be offset to a large extent by expenditure savings across ministries.

“For instance, Government of India's revenue expenditure needs to expand by a steep 30 per cent YoY during February-March 2026 to meet the FY2026 RE, entailing an incremental amount of Rs 2.3 lakh crore. Consequently, we do not expect a material fiscal slippage on this account,” Nayar said.

Cabinet clears amendments to insolvency & companies laws: Sources



NEW DELHI: The Union Cabinet on Tuesday approved amendments to the insolvency law and the Companies Act, according to sources.

Specific details could not be immediately ascertained.

The sources said the Cabinet has cleared various amendments to the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC) and the Companies Act, 2013.

Both laws are implemented by the corporate affairs ministry.

In August last year, the ministry had introduced a Bill in the Lok Sabha to amend the IBC, proposing a raft of changes, including provisions to reduce the time taken for admission of insolvency resolution applications. The Bill, which was referred to a select committee of the Lok Sabha, has also submitted its report in December 2025.

Last month, Finance and Corporate Affairs Minister Nirmala Sitharaman had said the government intends to introduce the IBC (Amendment) Bill, 2025 in the second half of the Budget session.

The session commenced on Monday.

Silver soars to ₹2.79L/kg as weak dollar boosts demand

Prices of 99.9 per cent pure gold jumped Rs 400, or 0.24 per cent, to Rs 1,64,700 per 10 grams

NEW DELHI: Silver prices surged by Rs 10,975 to Rs 2.79 lakh per kilogram in the national capital on Tuesday, while gold rose Rs 400, tracking strong global trends as a weak US dollar boosted demand for the safe-haven asset.

Ending its three-day losing streak, the white metal soared by Rs 10,975, or 4.09 per cent, to Rs 2,79,275 per kg (inclusive of all taxes) from Monday's closing level of Rs 2,68,300 per kg, as per the All India Sarafa Association.

Gold prices also moved higher, with the metal having 99.9 per cent purity rising by

CLOSER LOOK

» In global markets, spot silver gained \$1.38, to \$88.33 per ounce, while gold was trading at \$5,172.86/ounce

» ‘Gold & silver rebounded on Tuesday as pullback in US dollar, Treasury yields provided relief to precious metals’

» The dollar index retreated after touching 15-week high in previous session, making room for bullion prices to recover, creating room for bullion prices to recover

Rs 400, or 0.24 per cent, to Rs 1,64,700 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes).

In the international markets, spot silver gained \$1.38, or 1.6 per cent, to \$88.33 per ounce, while gold was trad-

ing nearly 1 per cent higher at \$5,172.86 per ounce.

“Gold and silver rebounded on Tuesday as a pullback in the US dollar and Treasury yields provided relief to precious metals,” Saumil Gandhi,

Senior Analyst - Commodities at HDFC Securities, said.

The dollar index retreated after touching a 15-week high in the previous session, while US Treasury bond yields also edged lower, creating room for bullion prices to recover, Gandhi added.

Echoing similar views, Kaynat Chainwala, AVP Commodity Research, Kotak Securities, said silver gained to trade around \$90 per ounce after Trump suggested that the Gulf conflict could end soon, easing inflation concerns, following the sharp correction in oil prices.

The dollar had initially strengthened when crude oil briefly surged toward \$119 per barrel, a move seen as potentially inflationary and supportive of a more hawkish policy stance from the Federal Reserve.

However, the sharp pullback in crude prices later in the session helped precious metals rebound from their earlier lows. “Gold was also supported by continued central bank demand, with the People's Bank of China extending its gold reserve purchases for a sixteenth consecutive month in February,” Chainwala said.

MUMBAI: Bank of Baroda (BoB) on Tuesday launched a premium savings product for women — the bob Women Sapphire Savings Account — offering a combination of banking, lifestyle and health benefits.

The account includes a Rs 10 lakh cancer care coverage plan for women aged 18-60 and complimentary online doctor consultations for up to six family members. Customers will also get concessions on medicines and pathology tests as part of the wellness package.

Account holders will receive the bob Bhoomi RuPay Select Debit Card, which

offers lifestyle benefits such as domestic airport lounge access, complimentary gym membership, health check-ups, spa or salon sessions and OTT subscriptions.

The account also provides a 50% first-year fee waiver, in the form of reward points, on the BOBCARD Tiara Credit Card, a women-focused premium credit card.

Additional benefits include a free women's health package, personal accident coverage and vouchers from brands such as Myntra, Nykaa, Flipkart and Lakme.

Customers will further benefit from discounted locker

charges and a 50% waiver on home loan pro-cessing fees, along with other banking privileges. The account requires a monthly average balance of Rs 1 lakh.

Dr. Debadatta Chand, Managing Director and CEO of Bank of Baroda, said the new offering reflects the bank's focus on building women-centric financial solutions by combining wellness benefits with premi-um banking and lifestyle privileges.

He added that the initiative also aims to deepen the bank's engagement with the growing high-value women's deposit segment.

India eases FDI norms for China, other land border sharing nations

‘Investors with non-controlling land border countries, beneficial ownership of up to 10% shall be permitted under the automatic route’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government on Tuesday eased foreign direct investment (FDI) norms for China and other countries sharing land borders with India by allowing overseas firms having up to 10 per cent shareholder from these nations to invest in the country without mandatory approval.

Earlier, overseas firms with shareholders from these nations owning even a single share had to seek mandatory approval to invest in India in any sector.

However, other conditions of FDI norms, including sectoral caps and entry routes, will be applicable to these investments.

Also, these investments will be subjected to prior reporting of information/details to the DPIIT (department for promotion of industry and internal trade).

The government has amended the press note 3 of 2020 in this regard. The deci-



However, other conditions of FDI norms, including sectoral caps and entry routes, will be applicable to these investments

sion was taken in a meeting of the Union Cabinet chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

The amendment in the press note provides for a definition and criteria for the determination of ‘Beneficial Ownership’ that is widely used by the investing community, under the Prevention of Money Lau-

Highlights

- » Also, these investments will be subjected to prior reporting of information/details to the DPIIT
- » The govt has amended the press note 3 of 2020 in this regard. The decision was taken in a Union Cabinet meeting
- » The government has also decided on expeditious clearance of investment proposals from LBCs in specific sectors

ndering Rules, 2003.

The beneficial ownership test will be applied at the level of the investor entity.

“Investors with non-controlling land border countries (LBC), beneficial ownership of up to 10 per cent shall be permitted under the automatic route as per the applicable sectoral caps, entry routes, atten-

dant conditions,” an official statement said.

The government has also decided on expeditious clearance of investment proposals from LBCs in specific sectors.

Under this, proposals for LBC investments in specified sectors/activities of manufacturing in capital goods, electronic capital goods, electronic components, polysilicon and ingot-wafer or any other sector/activity added by the committee of secretaries headed by the Cabinet Secretary will be processed and decided within 60 days.

In these cases, the majority shareholding and control of the investee entity will be with resident Indian citizen(s) and/or resident Indian entity(ies) owned and controlled by resident Indian citizen(s), at all times.

In order to curb opportunistic takeovers/acquisitions of Indian companies due to the COVID-19 pandemic, the government had amended the FDI policy through Press Note 3

(2020) on April 17, 2020.

Following that, an entity of a country which shares a land border with India or where the beneficial owner of an investment into India is situated in or is a citizen of any such country, can invest only after getting permission from the government.

Additionally, any transfer of ownership of any existing or future FDI in an entity in India resulting in the beneficial ownership falling within these jurisdictions also requires government approval.

This rule was seen as adversely affecting investment flows from investors, including global funds such as PE/VC funds.

It is expected that the new guidelines will provide clarity and ease of doing business in India, and facilitate investments which can contribute towards greater FDI inflows, access to new technologies, domestic value addition, expansion of domestic firms and integration with the global supply chain.

Govt directs shipping operators to refrain from predatory pricing

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI/NEW DELHI: Shipping sector regulator Directorate General of Shipping has advised shipping companies, vessel operators and agents to refrain from “predatory, non-transparent and opportunistic pricing” practices in the wake of disruptions due to the West Asia conflict, according to sources.

In an advisory issued on Monday, the DGS also asked them to ensure that all applicable charges are communicated clearly and upfront to exporters, importers and other stakeholders.

The DGS advisory came following the regulator receiving representations from various stakeholders in the EXIM trade regarding the levy of multiple ancillary charges by shipping lines/carriers and their agents.

These charges are perceived to be “non-transparent and opportunistic in nature”, resulting in an escalation in transaction costs in the logistics chain, DGS said. Besides, it said, they appear to be taking undue advantage of the prevailing geopolitical tensions and war-like situation, it said.

“In the interest of promoting transparency, fairness and predictability in the EXIM



logistics ecosystem, all shipping lines, carriers and their agents are hereby advised to refrain from predatory, non-transparent and opportunistic pricing practices, including levy of exorbitant charges thereby taking undue advantage of prevailing geo-political issue,” the advisory stated.

“They must should adhere to fair trade practices and avoid the levy of charges that may give rise to disputes within the EXIM trade and ensure that all applicable charges are communicated clearly and upfront to exporters, importers and other stakeholders,” it added. Freight rates have risen sharply in recent days as military tensions in the Middle East continue to escalate, with Iran, the US and Israel attacking one another.

An executive of a global shipping company said the ongoing conflict in the Middle East is forcing companies to take longer routes to deliver shipments covering entire Africa.

Air India & AI Express to levy fuel surcharge on tickets

NEW DELHI: Air India and Air India Express will start levying a fuel surcharge of Rs 399 on each domestic flight ticket from March 12 and also hike the charge for international bookings due to a steep rise in jet fuel prices amid the Middle East conflict.

The new fuel surcharges will be implemented in a phased manner.

In the first phase, a fuel surcharge of Rs 399 per domestic flight ticket would be imposed from March 12, and the same will also be applicable for SAARC flights, a statement said on Tuesday.

For West Asia flights, the fuel surcharge will be \$10 and hiked by \$30 to \$90 for Africa flights, and by \$20 to \$60 for Southeast Asia services.

All these changes will be effective from March 12, including for flights to and from Singapore. Currently, there is no fuel surcharge for the Singapore services. PTI

Supreme Court upholds Bharti Telecom’s share capital reduction

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court of India on Tuesday dismissed a batch of appeals filed by minority shareholders of Bharti Telecom Ltd, upholding the company’s decision to reduce its share capital and buy out small investors.

A bench comprising Justices Sanjay Kumar and K Vinod Chandran said the valuation of shares is an expert exercise and found that the company had followed due legal procedure under the Companies Act.

The case relates to a 2018 decision by Bharti Telecom Ltd

— the promoter of Bharti Airtel Ltd — to reduce its share capital by cancelling shares held by minority investors, who together owned about 1.09 per cent of the company.

The company had initially offered Rs 163.25 per share to the minority shareholders. The National Company Law Tribunal later raised the value to Rs 196.80 per share after removing a tax deduction from the calculation.

However, a group of 35 shareholders challenged the move in the apex court, alleg-

ing that the valuation was a “sham”, the price offered was arbitrarily low and the notice for the shareholders’ meeting was misleading.

Rejecting the appeals, the court observed that the investors were seasoned market participants who chose to hold the shares despite the company being unlisted and offering no dividend, liquidity or exit options for years.

The bench said the company’s process of capital reduction and shareholder exit complied with legal requirements. AGENCIES

RIL will maximise LPG production, divert KG-D6 gas to priority sector

NEW DELHI: Mukesh Ambani-led Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL) on Tuesday said it will maximise LPG production at its Jamnagar refining complex and divert natural gas from the KG-D6 Basin to priority sectors to help cushion the impact of disruptions caused by the West Asia conflict.

The move comes after the Government of India redirected supplies of liquefied petroleum gas away from industrial users to households to shield consumers from rising energy costs linked to the war in the Middle



East. Refineries have also been asked to increase LPG output to meet domestic demand.

Reliance said its refining and petrochemical complexes at Jamnagar Refinery Complex — the world’s largest integrated refining hub — are working to

maximise cooking gas production. “At a time when global energy markets are experiencing volatility, ensuring uninterrupted access to essential fuels for Indian households remains a national priority,” the company said in a statement.

It added that gas produced from the KG-D6 fields will be redirected to priority sectors in line with government guidelines and national energy priorities. Reliance said it will continue to work closely with the government to support India’s energy security. AGENCIES

RBI caps banks’ dividend at 75% of PAT from FY27

MUMBAI: The RBI has capped the maximum dividend by banks to shareholders at 75 per cent of profit after tax (PAT), with effect from FY27. The central bank on Tuesday issued the RBI (Commercial Banks – Prudential Norms on Declaration of Dividend and Remittances of Profits) Directions, 2026.

According to the norms, the regulatory capital of the bank should not fall below the applicable regulatory capital requirement even after the payment of dividends. Also, a foreign bank operating in India in branch

mode should have positive PAT for the period for which the profits are to be remitted to the Head Office.

“A (bank) may declare & pay dividend up to the limits prescribed... but in aggregate not exceeding 75 per cent of the PAT for the period for which the dividend is being proposed,” it said. The directions will come into effect from the FY27.

The RBI has also issued prudential norms on declaration of dividend for small finance banks, local area banks, payment banks, & RRBs. PTI

Sport

In company of greats

Feels good to join the elite company of Rohit and Dhoni: Suryakumar



Suryakumar Yadav said the next target is the Olympics gold PTI

MUMBAI: Two days after captaining India to a T20 World Cup title, Suryakumar Yadav is slowly taking in the enormity of the achievement that has put him in august company of Kapil Dev, M S Dhoni and Rohit Sharma, who too helped the team lift ICC trophies.

Soon after returning from Ahmedabad, where India won a record third T20 World Cup title on Sunday, Suryakumar reflected on the side’s successful campaign and the road ahead.

“It feels good to win 24 and 26 back-to-back. It is a very special feeling. When we won in 2024, we thought it would be so special to do this again at home in 2026,” Surya said.

“The next target is to win the Olympics gold in 2028. The team has a good momentum. If India wins the T20 World Cup in the same year, it will be great.”

On being compared to the likes of Rohit and Dhoni, he added: “It feels good to join that elite company. I am slowly feeling it. It is a very special feeling to be talked about among such great people. I will try to do the same in the future and help India win more trophies.”

Rohit was the captain when India ended an ICC trophy

BCCI announces Rs 131 cr cash reward for champions

NEW DELHI: The BCCI on Tuesday announced a cash reward of Rs 131 crore for the entire Indian squad following its third T20 World Cup victory. The amount covers 15 players, coaching staff, other support staff.

As per sources, the players are certain to get lion’s share of the reward money while support staff amount will be decided as per hierarchy.

The amount is an increment of Rs 6 crore from the drought with the win in Barbados back in June 2024. Dhoni led India to victories in 2007 T20 World Cup and 2011 ODI World Cup.

Kapil Dev’s team won the 1983 ODI World Cup, the first major title for the country.

Speaking to reporters outside his residence, Suryakumar revealed that he had spoken to Dhoni ahead of the ICC event.

“I had met him (M S Dhoni) before the tournament and he told me how to approach an ICC tournament. He told me that we have a good team, we

just have to be courageous and we will definitely win. His reaction after the win was amazing,” said the skipper.

The country is celebrating the win and the team too duly celebrated through the night post the final on Sunday.

“I wish I could share everything what we have done on that night after being world champions but then we had a good time we were awake till 8 AM in the morning,” Suryakumar said. He is now looking forward to the IPL beginning March 28. AGENCIES

WORKLOAD PLAN FOR PACER Bumrah to dial down T20Is? 2027 ODI WC comes into picture

NEW DELHI: India’s pace spearhead Jasprit Bumrah is likely to play more 50-over games instead of T20I bilateral series over the next 18 months to ensure his preparations for the 2027 ODI World Cup remain on track.

T20Is will be a low priority leading up to October-November 2027, despite a heavy schedule of bilateral series and the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan, where Suryakumar Yadav is expected to lead the side.

It is understood that Bumrah, like many senior Indian players, is very keen on playing the Los Angeles Olympics in 2028, which will be held in the T20 format, but ODIs will be his primary white ball format till the 2027 World Cup.

India’s ODI World Cup preparation will start in earnest after a gruelling two months of the Indian Premier League where Bumrah is set to headline the Mumbai Indians pace attack. By the end of the IPL, it is understood that the national selection committee, the Centre of Excellence headed by VVS Laxman and the team management represented by Gautam Gambhir and Shubman Gill, will prepare the blue-print for the next phase, and the most important aspect will be Bum-



NZ’s Finn Allen bats at nets on Saturday as Tim Seifert looks on PTI

T20Is will be a low priority leading up to Oct-Nov 2027, despite a heavy schedule of bilateral series

rah’s workload management.

It is understood that the World Test Championships (WTC) matches are non-negotiable for the 32-year-old legend and it is believed that his workload management will be somewhat similar to the 2023-2026 phase during which he didn’t play a single ODI.

Since November 19, 2023, when the last ODI World Cup final was held against Austra-

lia, Bumrah played 42 games, which included 21 Test matches and an equal number of T20Is.

“Obviously Bumrah’s fitness is as always key to any of India’s global campaign and hence the Indian team management will have to be very careful and prioritise the formats. Keep Test cricket aside, which he will obviously play, but in the 50-over World Cup cycle, he will concentrate more on ODIs. There will be around 30-35 odd games and one can’t take chances,” a BCCI source said. India’s pace bowling pool in terms of ODI cricket isn’t a big one but it is understood that the core will comprise Bumrah, Mohammed Siraj, Arshdeep Singh and Harshit Rana (when-ever he gets fit). AGENCIES

AFC WOMEN’S ASIAN CUP India’s campaign ends with a whimper, lose 1-3

SYDNEY: A profligate India bowed out of the AFC Women’s Asian Cup with a 1-3 defeat to Chinese Taipei in their must-win last group stage fixture here on Tuesday, paying a heavy price for the lack of finishing touches.

Despite dominating large portions of the game and creating numerous opportunities, the India’s inability to con-

vert chances in the final third proved costly, leading to an early exit after they qualified for the prestigious tournament on merit for the first time.

Manisha Kalyan scored India’s lone goal in the 39th minute, the winger unleashing a powerful shot from about 30 yards to find the target.

Chinese Taipei took the lead in the 12th minute when

Y H Su slotted the ball inside an empty goal post after a horrible back pass from Sanju to J W Chen. Indian custodian Elangbam Panthoi Chanu had come off her line hoping to stop Chen, who successfully squared the ball to Su.

India struck back after that, but just before half time (45+9), Y. Y. Hsu’s shot hit the upright corner of the post and deflected

off Panthoi to enter the India goal.

This was after Pyari Xaxa handled the ball inside the box and referee pointed to the spot.

The contest was as good as over when Yu-Chin Chen struck Chinese Taipei’s third goal in the 77th minute, getting the better of Panthoi after a run down the right side. AGENCIES

‘Disheartened’ Lakshya down, but not out

NEW DELHI: Lakshya Sen admits the physical demands of modern men’s singles are forcing him to rethink recovery and preparation, even as the Indian badminton ace continues to feel “a little bit disheartened” after falling short in his second All England final.

Lakshya battled through a series of long matches during a taxing week in Birmingham before finishing runner-up to Chinese Taipei’s Lin Chun-yi.



“It’s been a good week overall, but also an emotional week.

Getting into finals for the second time and not winning, it feels a bit disheartened after the match. But overall, if I look back at the tournament, some good wins, a good run and the way I played, I think something to look forward to in the coming tournaments,” the 24-year-old told reporters on Tuesday.

Lakshya had spent more than five hours on court during the week, including a gruelling semifinal in which he battled

severe cramps, before going down narrowly in the final.

The experience, he said, reinforced the importance of balancing tournament schedules with recovery and structured training blocks. “It has been very physical in the matches and tournaments and also with the age, I mean, I’m not 20 anymore to recover as fast as I am,” Lakshya said. He said managing workload has also become crucial. AGENCIES

HELLO BACHHON REVIEW

INSIDE INDIA'S EXAM FACTORIES

Hello Bachhon goes beyond the coaching boom to reveal pressures behind obsession with ranks

SURBHI GARG

"In India, a classroom can feel like a battlefield of dreams."

Right from the moment you watch the trailer or the teaser of *Hello Bachhon*, you would assume it to be yet another inspirational story about yet another teacher trying to do some kind of revolution for students. But, as you continue watching this 5-episode series, it unhurriedly reveals its layers. Set in the backdrop of India's fiercely competitive coaching industry, the Netflix drama is about a smalltown physics teacher from Uttar Pradesh whose belief in accessible education takes the shape of a movement among thousands appearing for medical and engineering entrance exams. Inspired by the real-life journey behind the educational platform PhysicsWallah, the show explores the stark realities hidden behind the



culture of all-India ranks - pressure, relentless competition, anxiety and in some tragic cases, the shadow of student suicides.

A teacher, played by Viineet Kumar, refuses to treat education merely as a commercial enterprise and is an unlikely rebel in a realm dominated by corporate coaching chains. The series builds its emotional core around the students who carry the expectations of their families and see education as the only ladder to uplift their social existence. *Hello Bachhon* taps into a very Indian aspect of education - the quiet heroism of a teacher and the nearly 'mythic' faith placed in the education system. What makes the series more intriguing is how it explores the ecosystem sur-

rounding competitive exams - parents investing their life savings in coaching institutes, students' struggle with exhaustion, teachers' fight between idealism and financial survival, and the emergence of coaching institutes as a parallel to the schooling system.

Viineet Kumar carries the role of the protagonist with a performance that feels more grounded rather than theatrical. He plays the role of the teacher not as a larger than life saviour, but as someone constantly battling practical constraints. Not just Viineet, supporting performances from Vikram Kochhar and Girija Oak Godbole add further depth to the narrative by portraying colleagues and family members who both support and question the protagonist's mission. This balance ensures that there is no excessive melodrama, but instead quiet emotional beats upon a student struggling with self-doubt, a parent silently counting expenses, or a teacher wondering if idealism can survive a world that is driven by the market.

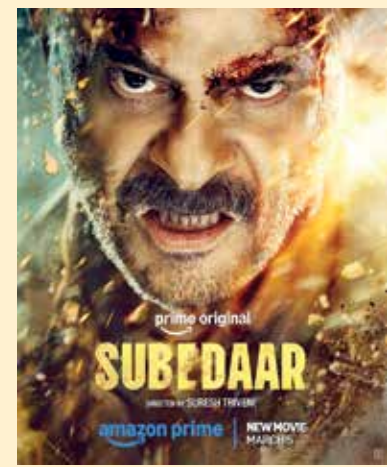
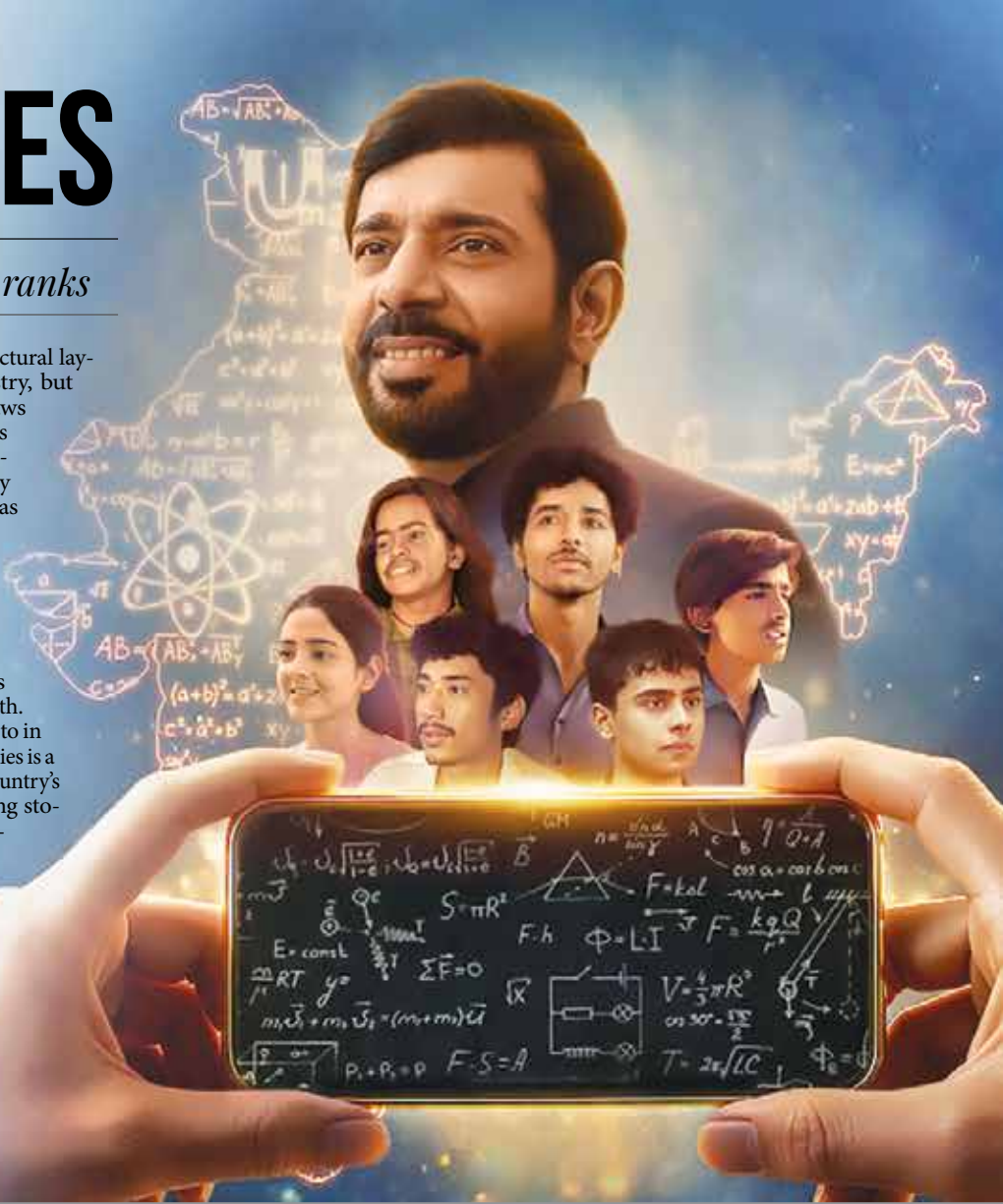
However, *Hello Bachhon* doesn't come without shortcomings. The storytelling across several points becomes predictable - the lone idealist versus the entrenched system. Certain characters feel underdeveloped despite their narrational importance. The series also

simplifies the complex structural layers in the coaching industry, but having said that, these flaws don't entirely undermine its impact. It succeeds in bringing to life the extraordinary power of education, both as aspiration and anxiety.

In a streaming landscape, crowded with crime thrillers and glitzy spectacles, a series on education and students might feel very modest. But, its modesty is its precise strength. A story that we all can relate to in some way or another. The series is a reminder that some of the country's most dramatic and inspiring stories unfold not just in boardrooms or battlefields, but in cramped classrooms with many chasing the same dream.

WORTH YOUR TIME!

GO BINGE-WATCH IT. YOU WON'T BE LEFT DISAPPOINTED.



'Subedar' team dominates 'IMDb Popular Indian Celebrities List'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The 'IMDb Popular Indian Celebrities' list this week highlights the strong presence of the cast and creator behind 'Subedar'.

Aditya Rawal has secured the 1st position on the list, while his co-stars Radhikka Madan and Mona Singh have taken the 4th and 10th spots, respectively. Director Suresh Triveni is also featured on the list, ranking 13th.

Meanwhile, the cast of 'Accused' has also made a mark on the list this week. Pratibha Ranta ranked 3rd, while Konkona Sen Sharma secured the 7th position following the film's recent release on a streaming platform.

'I wasn't a very confident dancer'

In an 'Instagram' post, Zeenat Aman went down memory lane



Zeenat Aman said she was never a confident dancer and directors soon realised that it was better to leave her to groove rather than force her to perform complicated choreography.

In an 'Instagram' post, Aman went down the memory lane and shared a video clip of 'Oh Diwano Dil Samhalo' from her 1979 hit 'The Great Gambler' with Amitabh Bachchan.

"As I've mentioned before, I wasn't a very confident dancer as I never had formal training, unlike most of the actresses of the time. Still, I could 'groove' and many a director realised it's better to leave me to my own swaying device than frustrate themselves trying to coax complicated choreography out of me! Anyway, enjoy this snippet. P S: Can you guess who sang this number?" she shared in a post on Monday.

Calling the song, which was sung by Asha Bhosle, her personal favourite, Aman said it depicted 'the confidence and sass of a woman who knows her desirability.' "Another hit from 'The Great Gambler'! 'Do Lafzon Ki' was the movie's most loved

song by popular consensus, but this one is my personal favourite. None of that drippy romance stuff here. Just the confidence and sass of a woman who knows her desirability," she wrote.

She added, "The sequence had three outfit changes, of which the shimmering gold track-pant set (not featured in this clip, but you can find it on 'YouTube') tickled me the most! Not only was the outfit completely over the top, but the hair team also

She shared a video clip of 'Oh Diwano Dil Samhalo' from her 1979 hit 'The Great Gambler'

decided to give me a short page-boy wig to go with and the dance master decided to add in some high kicks for good measure."

The Shakti Samanta-directed film had R D Burman as the music director. It revolved around Bachchan's dual role as Jai, an expert gambler working for an underworld don and Vijay, a CID inspector. Aman played Shabnam in the movie, who falls for Jai. The film also featured Neetu Singh, Prem Chopra, Utpal Dutt, Madan Puri, Helen, Iftekhar and others.

A NEW COLLABORATION

Arnold to reprise his role in 'Conan' movie

Hollywood action icon Arnold Schwarzenegger is set to reprise one of his most iconic roles as director Christopher McQuarrie has been attached to write and direct 'King Conan' for '20th Century Studios'.

According to 'The Hollywood Reporter', McQuarrie, who helmed the four most recent entries in Tom Cruise's 'Mission: Impossible' franchise, will helm the project that would see Schwarzenegger return to the sword-and-sorcery role he first played in the 1982 fantasy film 'Conan the Barbarian' and its 1984 sequel, both based on the character created by author Robert E Howard.

Schwarzenegger made the announcement at the Arnold Sports Festival in Columbus, Ohio, over the weekend, describing the film's premise to the assembled crowd. "It's a great story where Conan was a king for 40 years and he gets complacent and now he gets forced out of the kingdom, slowly," the actor said, adding that the story would involve 'all kinds of madness and violence and magic and creatures'.

The 77-year-old star noted that modern visual effects technology and studio resources would allow the project to be realised on a far grander scale than its predecessors.

The project has had a long road to the screen. 'Universal Pictures' previously held the rights to the character in the early 2010s, with 'Fast & Furi-



Schwarzenegger announced at the Arnold Sports Festival in Columbus, Ohio

ous' writer Chris Morgan developing an 'unforgiven-style story for Schwarzenegger's older Conan.

Besides 'King Conan', Schwarzenegger revealed he has been in discussions with director Dan Trachtenberg - who revived the 'Predator' franchise with 2022's 'Prey' and last year's 'Predator: Badlands' - about a possible return to that series. He also disclosed that he has received a script for 'Commando 2'.

THE WEEK INDIA ACCIDENTALLY PROGRAMMED A FILM FESTIVAL

AUTHOR



DARSHIM SAXENA

In contemporary India, the difference between history and mythology is packaging

India's news cycle accidentally programmed a film festival with four releases, each in a different genre. The men's T20 final arrived as a blockbuster - India 255/5, New Zealand 159, a 96-run win that played less like a match and more like a coronation. Sanju Samson's 89 and Bumrah's 4/15 functioned like star turns to be cut into a trailer.

Cut to: 'IndiGo' releasing a social media film announcing that over 1,000 of their pilots are now women. 17-and-a-half per cent of the workforce. In India, milestones rarely travel as numbers. They travel as edited stories.

Cut to: Hyderabad. The Indian women's hockey team beat Uruguay 4-0 in the FIH World Cup qualifiers. Sunelita Toppo scored. Then Ishika. Then Lalremisiami. Names that should be spoken like dialogue. Dialogue is how audiences learn to remember. Yet the qualifier was an under-distributed indie that played to an empty house.

Cut to: The Reserve Bank of India, the following morning, launching 'Digital Payment Awareness Week' with a single, quiet line. To receive money, you never need to scan a QR code or enter a PIN. Minimalist scriptwriting. A disclaimer dressed as a civic announcement.

The stories are not unequal in



India celebrates its dominant T20 final victory over New Zealand. Sporting spectacles often arrive pre-packaged for mythology, long before

importance. They are unequal in packaging. In contemporary India, packaging is the difference between what enters national memory and what does not.

The T20 win arrived pre-edited. The narrative arc with India losing to New Zealand in 2019, losing again in 2021, winning in 2023, dominating in 2026 is loss, loss, revenge, dominance. A screenwriter encountering

this material would call it scaffolding. It has pre-built tension, pre-existing audience investment and outcomes already inscribed in collective memory before a single frame is shot.

Kabir Khan's '83' (2021) understood this perfectly. A match becomes myth not when it is played, but when it is replayed. Cinema manufactures definitive replay.

Cricket became India's national

religion because every stage of the loop was deliberately built. The camera language is already there. The power-play as montage, the star bowler as an inevitable plot device and the stadium as a cathedral. It was padded with training pipelines,

the IPL, broadcast rights, endorsement ecosystems and then cinema, converting the whole apparatus into mythology, feeding the aspiration of the next generation. The pipeline preceded the passion. The passion felt inevitable only in retrospect.

'Chak De! India' (2007) demonstrates how cinema manufactures that memory. The final sequence begins with long shots that render the team as anonymous figures in a hostile stadium, then moves into tight close-ups before each penalty stroke, granting every player a brief moment of narrative subjectivity.

Sjoerd Marijne returned to coach the Indian women's team in 2026.

Public conversation instinctively reached for 'Chak De! India' as the explanatory frame. Marijne's documented address to the 2026 squad was blunt and tactical: "I know you can score one or two goals every match. You need to score more." The 'sattar' minute speech will be quoted for another decade. Marijne's actual

words won't be cited anywhere.

IndiGo's 17.5 per cent is also the product of a pipeline. Low-cost aviation created institutional demand at a scale that outpaced older gate-keeping logic. The achievement preceded any cinematic attention by years. This is the sharper point. The women already in those cockpits didn't require mythology to get there.

Cinema knows how to eroticise infrastructure when it wants to. A railway platform becomes an original story. A cockpit pipeline remains a statistic. 'Chak De! India' proved in 2007 that the machinery works. The question for Indian cinema isn't whether it can tell these stories. It is whether the industry will engage before it finds itself, as it does right now, reaching for a 19-year-old screenplay to explain a real team that is already, quietly, ahead of the fiction.

Meanwhile, the infrastructure continues quietly, like a background score that few audiences consciously notice. Planes depart. Payments clear. Qualifiers are played. The spectacle will come later, because a match becomes history when it is played. It becomes mythology only when someone decides it is worth replaying.

Darshim Saxena writes on cinema and culture

Some events arrive already shaped for replay, while others remain unedited achievements waiting for their narrative moment

Format C-1
(for candidate to publish in Newspapers, TV)

Declaration about criminal cases
(As per the judgment dated 25th September, 2018, of Hon’ble Supreme Court in WP (Civil) No. 536 of 2011 (Public Interest Foundation & Ors. Vs. Union of India &Anr.)

Name and address of candidate: : **SHRI BABUL SUPRIYA BARAL of IDEAL GRAND, 16 B & C, 16th Floor, Block B Resplanda, 456, G. T. Road South, Near Shibpur Police Line, Shibpur, Haora (M. Corp), P.O- Sibpur Bazar, Dist- Howrah, West Bengal-711102**

Name of political party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**
(Independent candidates should write “Independent” here)

Name of Election: **BIENNIAL ELECTION TO THE COUNCIL OF STATES TO FILL UP FIVE SEATS FROM WEST BENGAL 2026**

*Name of Constituency: **WEST BENGAL**

I **BABUL SUPRIYA BARAL**(name of candidate), a candidate for the abovementioned election, declare for public information the following details about my criminal antecedents:

(A) Pending criminal cases

Sl. No.	Name of Court	Case No. and dated	Status of case(s)	Section(s) of Acts concerned and brief description of offence(s)14
1	Court of the LD MPS & MLAS Court, Barasat, North 24 PGS. LD. Judge Special Court	FIR Case No. 129/14 Dt. 12/04/14	Charges Not Framed	186/143/283 of the Indian Penal Code and 8(B)(II) NH Act 1956. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly and obstruction of public servants in the discharge of their duties.
2	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	Case No. 84/16 Dt. 09/04/16	Charges Not Framed	188 of the Indian Penal Code and 32 of the Police Act. Allegations relating to disobedience of an order duly promulgated by a public servant.
3	Court of the LD. A.C.JM Alipore Bankshall Court	FIR Case No.129 Dt. 29/04/16	Charges Not Framed	504 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to intentional insult with intent to provoke a person.
4	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	Case No. 438/16 Dt. 21/10/16	Charges Not Framed	166/323/353/355 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to disobedience of law by a public servant.
5	Court of the LD. MPS & MLAS Court, Barasat, North 24 PGS. LD. Judge Special Court	FIR Case No. 62 Dt 04/01/17	Charges Not Framed	509 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to the use of words, gestures, or acts intended to insult the modesty of a woman.
6	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	FIR Case No. 97/18 Dt 29/03/18GR No.901/2016	Charges Not Framed	143/147/149/ 153A/186/ 188/ 353 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly.
7	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	Case No. 95/19 Dt. 19.3.2019	Charges Not Framed	500/504/506/509 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to defamation, intentional insult with intent.
8	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	FIR NGR No. 948/19 Dt. 18/04/19	Charges Not Framed	171C/268/427 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to undue influence in connection with an election.

(B) Details about cases of conviction for criminal offences

Sl. No.	Name of Court & date(s) of order(s)	Description of offence(s) & punishment imposed	Maximum Punishment Imposed
1.	N/A	N/A	N/A
2.	N/A	N/A	N/A
3.	N/A	N/A	N/A

9	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	Case No. 171/19 Dt. 21/04/19	Charges Not Framed	143/342/186/353/506 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly.
10	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	Case No. 113 of 2019 Dt. 14/04/19	Charges Not Framed	143/186/283/506 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly and obstruction of public servants in the discharge of their duties
11	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	FIR Case No. 40/19 Dt. 29/04/19	Charges Not Framed	353/186/188/506/120B of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to obstruction and use of criminal force against public servants
12	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	FIR Case No. 32/19 Dt. 2019	Charges Not Framed	143/147/149/153A/ 186/188/353 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to unlawful assembly and rioting by members of a group
13	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	FIR NGR No. 34/19 Dt. 2019	Charges Not Framed	Information Not Available
14	Court of the LD. ACJM, Alipore	FIR Case No. 347 Dt 22/09/19	Charges not framed	341/323/34/354/ 506/509 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to wrongful restraint and voluntarily causing hurt
15	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	FIR NGR No. 995/19 Dt. 2019	Charges Not Framed	171C/500 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to undue influence in connection with an election and defamation
16	Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol	Case No. 150 of Dt. 01.06.2019	Charges Not Framed	Offences under Sections 336/504 of IPC. 419/506 of the Indian Penal Code. Allegations relating to cheating by personation and criminal intimidation
17	Court of the LD. ACJM Alipore	FIR Case No. 78 Dt.09/05/20	Charges Not Framed	153A/505/120B of the Indian Penal Code and RW 66/43 Information Technology Act. Allegations relating to promoting enmity between differentgroups and making statements that may incite public mischief.
18	Court of the LD. ACJM Alipore	FIR Case No. 31 Dt. 31/03/21	Charges Not Framed	506 of the Indian Penal Code. Alleged criminal intimidation

*In the case of election to Council of States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of constituency

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RAAJMARG INFRA INVESTMENT TRUST

The Trust has been registered in the Republic of India as an irrevocable trust set up under the Indian Trusts Act, 1882, on November 24, 2025, and registered as an infrastructure investment trust under the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Infrastructure Investment Trusts) Regulations, 2014, on December 22, 2025, having registration number IN/InvIT/25-26/0034.

Principal Place of Business: G - 5 & 6, Sector 10, Dwarka, New Delhi – 110 075; Telephone: +91 11 2507 4100/200 - 3211; Compliance Officer: Gunjan Rajpal; E-mail: compliance@riimpl.in; Website: www.raajmarginfrastrust.in

SPONSOR	INVESTMENT MANAGER	TRUSTEE
		 IDBI Trusteeship Services Ltd
NATIONAL HIGHWAYS AUTHORITY OF INDIA	RAAJMARG INFRA INVESTMENT MANAGERS PRIVATE LIMITED	IDBI TRUSTEESHIP SERVICES LIMITED

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UP TO [●] UNITS OF RAAJMARG INFRA INVESTMENT TRUST (“TRUST”) FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER UNIT TOGETHER WITH SPONSOR CONTRIBUTION AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 60,000.00 MILLION (“ISSUE”). THE ISSUE IS AN INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER IN RELIANCE UPON REGULATION 14(4) OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (INFRASTRUCTURE INVESTMENT TRUSTS) REGULATIONS, 2014, AS AMENDED (“INVIT REGULATIONS”).

Price Band: ₹99 to ₹100 per Unit

Bidders (other than Anchor Investors and Strategic Investors) can make Bids for a minimum of 150 Units and in multiples of 150 Units thereof

Minimum Bid Size for Bidders other than Anchor Investors and Strategic Investors - ₹14,850

RISKS TO INVESTORS:

- The Trust is a newly settled trust with no operating history and limited historical financial information and, as a result, investors may not be able to assess its prospects on the basis of past records and the financial information disclosed in the Offer Document.
- The Project SPV has not executed the concession for InvIT Assets with the concessioning authority.

- The Trust must maintain certain investment ratios, which may present additional risks to the Trust.
- The ability of the Trust to make or maintain consistency in distributions to Unitholders depends on the financial performance of the Project SPV and their profitability.

Credit Ratings: (i) (a) Provisional CARE AAA: Stable from CARE Ratings Limited for the proposed bank loan facilities aggregating to ₹40,000.00 million to be availed by the Trust; and (b) Provisional CARE AAA: Stable, from CARE Ratings Limited as issuer rating. and (ii) (a) Provisional Ind AAA/Stable from India Ratings & Research Private Limited for the proposed bank loan facilities aggregating to ₹40,000.00 million to be availed by the Trust; and (b) Provisional Ind AAA/Stable as issuer rating from India Ratings & Research Private Limited.

BID ISSUE/PROGRAM	BID/ISSUE OPENS TODAY	BID/ISSUE CLOSING ON FRIDAY, MARCH 13, 2026*
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*The Investment Manager may in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers, consider closing the Bid/ Issue Period for QIBs one Working Day prior to the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, in accordance with the InvIT Regulations.

ASBA[#]

Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

[#]Applications Supported by Blocked Amount (“ASBA”) is a better way of applying to Issues by simply blocking the fund in the bank account. For further details, check section on ASBA.

Mandatory in public issues. No cheque will be accepted.



UPI-Now available in ASBA for Individual Non-Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹ 500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. Individual Non-Institutional Investors also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors and Strategic Investors. UPI may be availed by Individual Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 500,000 in the Non-Institutional Category. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and abridged prospectus and also please refer to the section “Issue Information” on page 271 of the Offer Document. The Bid Cum Application Form and the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the websites of BSE Limited (“BSE”) and National Stock Exchange of India Limited (“NSE”, and together with BSE, the “Stock Exchanges”) and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmid=35 and <https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmid=43>, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI Mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. ICICI Bank Limited and HDFC Bank Limited have been appointed as the Sponsor Banks for the Issue, in accordance with the requirements of SEBI circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Issue related queries, please contact the Book Running Lead Managers (“BRLMs”) on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.

In case of any revision to the Price Band, the Bid/Issue Period will be extended by at least one Working Day, subject to the total Bid/Issue Period not exceeding 30 days, provided that there shall not be more than two revisions to the Price Band during the Bid/Issue Period. Any revision to the Price Band and the revised Bid/Issue Period, if applicable, will be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges during the Bid/Issue Period and by indicating the change on the websites of the Trust, the Sponsor, the Investment Manager, Book Running Lead Managers, Syndicate Members, SCSBs and Stock Exchanges.

In case of force majeure, banking strike or similar circumstances, the Bid/ Issue Period may, for reasons to be recorded in writing, be extended by a minimum period of three Working Days, subject to the total Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 30 days.

This Issue is being made through the Book Building Process and in compliance with the InvIT Regulations and the SEBI InvIT Master Circular, wherein not more than 75.00% of the Net Issue (excluding the Strategic Investor Portion) shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Institutional Investors, provided that the Investment Manager may, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers, allocate up to 60.00% of the Institutional Investor Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the InvIT Regulations and the SEBI InvIT Master Circular. Further, not less than 25.00% of the Net Issue (excluding the Strategic Investor Portion) shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Non-Institutional Investors, in accordance with the InvIT Regulations and the SEBI InvIT Master Circular, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. The Issue will also include participation by Strategic Investors, wherein not less than 5.00% of the Net Issue and not more than 25.00% of the Net Issue shall be allocated to the Strategic Investors in accordance with the InvIT Regulations and the SEBI InvIT Master Circular. All Bidders, other than Anchor Investors and Strategic Investors, are required to utilise the Application Supported by Blocked Amount (“ASBA”) process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID (in case of individual Non-Institutional Investors using the UPI Mechanism Bidding with a Bid Amount of ₹ 0.50 million or less), in which case the corresponding Bid Amounts will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks (“SCSBs”) or under the UPI Mechanism, as applicable, to participate in this Issue. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Anchor Investor Portion of the Issue through the ASBA process. For details, please see the section entitled “Issue Information” on page 271 of the Offer Document.

Bidders/Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN and the Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID available (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorized the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Issue, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as

available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Issue. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants’ sole risk.

LISTING: The Units to be offered pursuant to the Offer Document are proposed to be listed on the National Stock Exchange of India Limited (the “NSE”) and BSE Limited (the “BSE”, together with NSE, the “Stock Exchanges”). In-principle approval for listing of the Units has been received from BSE and NSE pursuant to letters, each dated February 13, 2026. For the purposes of the Issue, NSE is the Designated Stock Exchange. The Investment Manager shall apply to the Stock Exchanges for the final listing and trading approval, after the Allotment and the credit of the Units to the demat accounts of the Allottees.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (“SEBI”): It is to be distinctly understood that submission of Offer Document to SEBI should not in any way be deemed or construed that the same has been cleared or approved by SEBI. SEBI does not take any responsibility either for the financial soundness of any scheme or the project for which the Issue is proposed to be made or for the correctness of the statements made or opinions expressed in the Offer Document.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF NSE (the Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to the Offer Document for the full text of the Disclaimer clause of the BSE.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to the Offer Document for the full text of the Disclaimer clause of the BSE.

GENERAL RISKS: Investments in Units involve a degree of risk and Bidders should not invest any funds in this Issue unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. For taking an investment decision, Bidders must rely on their own examination of the Trust, the Units and this Issue. Bidders are advised to carefully read the section entitled “Risk Factors” on page 42 of the Offer Document before making an investment decision relating to this Issue. Each Bidder is advised to consult its own advisors in respect of the consequences of an investment in the Units being issued pursuant to this Issue. The Offer Document has been prepared by the Trust solely for providing information in connection with this Issue. The Securities and Exchange Board of India (“SEBI”) and the Stock Exchanges assume no responsibility for or guarantee the correctness or accuracy or adequacy of any statements made, opinions expressed or reports contained herein. Admission of the Units to be issued pursuant to this Issue for trading on the Stock exchanges should not be taken as an indication of the merits of the Trust or of the Units.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS				REGISTRAR TO THE ISSUE
 Complete Investment Banking Solutions			 Investment Banking	 EXPERIENCE TRANSFORMATION
SBI CAPITAL MARKETS LIMITED 1501, 15 th Floor, A & B Wing, Parinee Crescenzo Building, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 4196 8300; E-mail: raajmarg.ipo@sbicaps.com Investor grievance e-mail: investor.relations@sbicaps.com Contact person: Sanjay Sethia Website: www.sbicaps.com SEBI registration number: INM000003531	AXIS CAPITAL LIMITED 1 st Floor, Axis House, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai 400 025, Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 4325 2183 E-mail: raajmarg.ipo@axiscap.in Investor grievance e-mail: compliants@axiscap.com Contact person: Harish Patel/ Mayun Arya Website: www.axiscapital.co.in SEBI registration number: INM000012029	ICICI SECURITIES LIMITED ICICI Venture House, Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai 400 025, Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 6807 7100 E-mail: raajmarg.ipo@icicisecurities.com Investor grievance e-mail: customercare@icicisecurities.com Contact person: Shri Subramanyam / Sumit Singh Website: www.icicisecurities.com SEBI registration number: INM000011179	MOTILAL OSWAL INVESTMENT ADVISORS LIMITED Motilal Oswal Tower, Rahimtullah Sayani Road, Opposite Parel ST Depot, Prabhadevi, Mumbai – 400 025, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 7193 4380 E-mail: riit.ipo@motilaloswal.com Investor grievance e-mail: moialpreddressal@motilaloswal.com Contact person: Shashank Pisat/Sankita Ajinkya Website: www.motilaloswalgroup.com SEBI registration number: INM000011005	KFIN TECHNOLOGIES LIMITED Selenium, Tower B, Plot No-31 and 32, Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally, Hyderabad, Rangareddy - 500 032, Telangana, India Tel.: +91 1800 309 4001 / +91 40 6716 2222 E-mail: riimpl.invit@kfinitech.com Investor grievance e-mail: einward.ris@kfinitech.com Website: www.kfinitech.com Contact person: M. Murali Krishna SEBI registration number: INR000000221
CONTACT PERSON AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER				Bidders can contact the Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Issue in case of any pre-Issue or post-Issue related problems such as non-receipt of Allotment Advice/ letter of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Units in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders and non-receipt of funds by electronic mode.
Gunjan Rajpal, G - 5 & 6, Sector 10, Dwarka, New Delhi – 110 075; Telephone: +91 11 2507 4100/200 - 3211; E-mail: compliance@riimpl.in				

AVAILABILITY OF THE OFFER DOCUMENT: Investors are advised to refer to the Offer Document and the “Risk Factors” beginning on page 42 of the Offer Document before applying in the Issue. A copy of the Offer Document is made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in and is available on the websites of the Book Running Lead Managers, i.e., www.sbicaps.com and www.axiscapital.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com, www.motilaloswalgroup.com, the website of the InvIT at www.raajmarginfrastrust.in and the websites of the Stock Exchanges, for BSE at www.bseindia.com and for NSE at www.nseindia.com.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS: Bid-cum-Application Forms can be obtained from the principal place of business of Raajmarg Infra Investment Trust, Telephone: +91 11 2507 4100/200 - 3211 at the offices of the Book Running Lead Managers: **SBI CAPITAL MARKETS LIMITED**, Tel: +91 22 4196 8300, **AXIS CAPITAL LIMITED**, Tel: +91 22 4325 2183, **ICICI SECURITIES LIMITED**, Tel: +91 22 6807 7100 and **MOTILAL OSWAL INVESTMENT ADVISORS LIMITED**, Telephone: +91 22 7193 4380 and Syndicate Member: Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited and SBICAP Securities Limited and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members, SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Issue. Bid-cum-Application Forms will also be available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Sub-syndicate Members: Alankit Imaginations Limited, Almondz Global Securities Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Anand Share Consultancy, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C. Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited, Axis Securities Limited, Centrum Broking Limited, Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Pvt. Limited, Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd., G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited, HDFC Securities Limited, IIFL Capital Services Limited, Innovate Securities Pvt Limited, Jhaveri Securities, JM Financial Services Limited, Kalpataru Multiplier Limited, Kantilal Chhaganlal Securities Pvt.Ltd., Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Kotak Securities Limited, Lakshmiresh Investment & Securities Pvt Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Marwadi Shares & Finance, Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt Limited, Navvuna Wealth and Investment Limited (Edelweiss Broking Limited), Patel Wealth Advisors Pvt Limited, Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Ltd., Pravin Ratilal Share and Stock Brokers Ltd., RR Equity Brokers Pvt. Ltd., Sharekhan Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, SS Corporate Securities Limited, Tanna Financial Services, TradeBulls Securities (P) Limited, Upstox Securities Private Limited, Yes Securities (India) Limited

APPLICATIONS SUPPORTED BY BLOCKED AMOUNT (ASBA): Investors other than Anchor Investors and Strategic Investors, have to apply through the ASBA process. For details on the ASBA process, please refer to the details given in the ASBA Form and abridged offer document and also please refer to the section “Issue Information” beginning on page 271 of the Offer Document. ASBA Forms can also be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges. ASBA form can be obtained from the list of banks that is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in. ASBA Form can be obtained from Members of the Syndicate, SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs, the list of which is available on the website of SEBI.

ESCROW COLLECTION BANK, REFUND BANK AND SPONSOR BANK: ICICI Bank Limited

PUBLIC ISSUE ACCOUNT BANK AND SPONSOR BANK: HDFC Bank Limited

SPONSOR CONTRIBUTION BANK: Yes Bank Limited

UPI: UPI Bidders can also Bid through UPI Mechanism.

All capitalized terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the Offer Document.

Place: New Delhi
Date: March 10, 2026

For Raajmarg Infra Investment Trust
on behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Gunjan Rajpal
Compliance Officer

RAAJMARG INFRA INVESTMENT TRUST is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offer of its Units and has filed the Offer Document dated February 28, 2026 with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges. The Offer Document is made available on the website of the SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in as well as on the website of the Book Running Lead Managers i.e., SBI Capital Markets Limited at www.sbicaps.com, Axis Capital Limited at www.axiscapital.co.in, ICICI Securities Limited at www.icicisecurities.com and Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited at www.motilaloswalgroup.com, the website of the NSE at www.nseindia.com and the website of the BSE at www.bseindia.com and the website of the Trust at www.raajmarginfrastrust.in. Any potential investor should note that investment in Units involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risks, please see the section titled “Risk Factors” beginning on page 42 of the Offer Document. Potential investors should not rely on the Draft Offer Document for making any investment decision.

The Units have not been and will not be registered under the United States Securities Act of 1933, as amended (the “Securities Act”) and may not be offered or sold within the United States except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the Securities Act and applicable U.S. state securities laws. Accordingly, the Units are only being offered and sold outside the United States in “offshore transactions” as defined in and in reliance on Regulation S under the Securities Act (“Regulation S”) and the applicable law of the jurisdictions where such offers and sales are made.